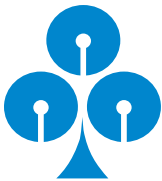


THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION, DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA.

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF EQUITY SHARES ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE") AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").



(Please scan the QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, the Abridged Prospectus and addendum to the RHP and the abridged prospectus.)



SBI FUNDS

MANAGEMENT LIMITED

SBI FUNDS MANAGEMENT LIMITED

(To be listed on the main board of BSE and NSE)

Our Company was originally incorporated as 'SBI Funds Management Private Limited' as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, at Mumbai, Maharashtra, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated February 7, 1992 ("Original COI") issued by the Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra. Pursuant to an intimation made by our Company under Section 43A(2) of the Companies Act, 1956, our Company was converted to a public limited company and the name of our Company changed to 'SBI Funds Management Limited'. Consequently, the Original COI was amended by the Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra to reflect such change in our name w.e.f. June 30, 1992. Following the subsequent deletion of Section 43A(2) of the Companies Act, 1956, our Company was converted to a private limited company pursuant to the resolutions of our Board and our Shareholders each dated May 16, 2001, and the name of our Company was changed to 'SBI Funds Management Private Limited'. Consequently, the Original COI was amended by the Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra to reflect such change in our name w.e.f. August 24, 2001. Subsequently, our Company was converted to a public limited company and the name of our Company changed to SBI Funds Management Limited pursuant to a resolution of our Board dated October 22, 2021 and our Shareholders dated November 23, 2021, and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated December 16, 2021 was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Mumbai. For further details, see "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" beginning on page 275 of the Red Herring Prospectus dated July 8, 2026 (the "*Red Herring Prospectus*" or "*RHP*") filed with the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai-I at Mumbai ("RoC").

Registered Office: 9th Floor, Crescenzo, C – 38 & 39, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India; Corporate Office: 9th Floor and Unit No. 1002, 1003 and 1004 of 10th Floor, Crescenzo, C – 38 & 39, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India; Tel: +91 22 6179 3000; Website: https://sbifunds.com/investor-relations; Contact person: Vinaya Datar (Chief Compliance Officer, Company Secretary and Head Legal); E-mail: companysecretary@sbimf.com; Corporate Identification Number: U65990MH1992PLC065289

THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY ARE STATE BANK OF INDIA, AMUNDI INDIA HOLDING AND AMUNDI ASSET MANAGEMENT

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO 170,956,631 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF SBI FUNDS MANAGEMENT LIMITED ("THE COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "OFFER") THROUGH AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 99,501,649 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION BY STATE BANK OF INDIA AND UP TO 71,454,982 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION BY AMUNDI INDIA HOLDING (COLLECTIVELY REFERRED TO AS "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND SUCH OFFER, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO 270,271 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO 0.01% OF THE POST OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE SBIFM EMPLOYEES (THE "SBIFM EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"), A RESERVATION OF UP TO 2,987,076 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO 0.15% OF THE POST OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE SBI EMPLOYEES (THE "SBI EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION" AND COLLECTIVELY WITH SBIFM EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION, THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO 13,055,629 EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO 7.64% OF THE OFFER SIZE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE SBI SHAREHOLDERS (AS DEFINED HEREINAFTER) ("SBI SHAREHOLDER RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE SBIFM EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION, SBI EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND SBI SHAREHOLDER RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE 8.39% AND 7.59%, RESPECTIVELY, OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE			
NAMES OF THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED/ AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
State Bank of India	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 99,501,649 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹ [●] million	0.15
Amundi India Holding	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 71,454,982 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹ [●] million	4.35

*As certified by Kirtane & Pandit LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN: 105215WW-100057), by way of their certificate dated July 10, 2026.

For further details, see "The Offer" beginning on page 72 of the RHP read with the addendum to the RHP and the abridged prospectus dated July 10, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹545 TO ₹574 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 545 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 574 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 26 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 26 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.

THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FINANCIAL YEAR ENDED 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 38.16 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 36.24 TIMES.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.

WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NETWORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 38.77%.

The details of the Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	OFFER SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION			
	At Floor Price of ₹545 per equity share		At Cap Price of ₹574 per equity share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Offer For Sale	170,956,631	92,995.47*	170,956,631	97,953.21*
Post Offer Market Capitalisation	2,036,827,612	1,110,071.05	2,036,827,612	1,169,139.05

*Offer size has been calculated considering the discount of ₹54 to eligible employees at floor price and cap price.

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME

BID/OFFER CLOSES TODAY*

*The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

Our Company functions as the investment manager to SBI Mutual Fund and its core businesses include managing mutual funds (including Specialised Investment Funds), providing Portfolio Management Services, managing Alternative Investment Funds, and providing advisory services to offshore clients.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE LIMITED AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED.

NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER • RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER

SBIFM EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO 270,271 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION

SBI EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO 2,987,076 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION

SBI SHAREHOLDER RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO 13,055,629 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP READ WITH THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS, EACH DATED JULY 8, 2026 AND THE ADDENDUM TO THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS DATED JULY 10, 2026 ("ADDENDUM") AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/ REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMS").

In accordance with the recommendation of a committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated July 8, 2026, the above provided price band is justified based on quantitative factors/ key performance indicators ("KPIs") disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 121 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s), as applicable, as disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section beginning on the page 121 of the RHP and provided below in this advertisement.

Risk to Investors

For details, refer to section titled "*Risk Factors*" on page 24 of the RHP.

1. **We are subject to extensive and evolving regulatory requirements:** The key regulatory requirements and prudential norms applicable to our Company include net worth / capital adequacy, Total Expense Ratio ("TER") / Base Expense Ratio ("BER") restrictions, investment, valuation and portfolio norms, governance and trustee oversight, risk management, compliance and SEBI inspections, cybersecurity, data protection and technology resilience, KYC, AML and investor protection. Introduction of the BER framework and reduction in TER caps under the SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulations directly reduce our management fee and TER income. Any changes to applicable laws, regulations or guidelines, or any adverse outcome from regulatory inspections, enquiries or investigations, including penalties, enhanced supervision may lead to suspension or cancellation of our registration, or reputational damage could have a material adverse effect on our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows.
2. **Scheme Underperformance Risk:** A significant number of our schemes have underperformed relative to benchmarks and peer schemes in the past three years. Underperformance relative to benchmarks in any given period may be driven by various factors and may persist across multiple periods. Any sustained underperformance of a significant number or proportion of our schemes, or the persistence of underperformance of existing bottom-quartile schemes, could result in increased investor redemptions, deterioration in our QAAUM, loss of market share, and reputational damage, each of which could have a material adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and prospects. The following table sets forth the number and percentage of our schemes (by category) that were ranked in the bottom quartile of their respective categories based on three-year returns, as at the relevant dates:

Period	Total Schemes	Bottom-Quartile Equity / Equity-Oriented Schemes	% of Equity / Equity-Oriented Schemes	Bottom-Quartile Debt Schemes	% of Debt Schemes	Bottom-Quartile Schemes (All Categories)	% of Total Schemes	AUM of Bottom-Quartile Schemes (₹ billion)	% of total ranked AUM
As at March 31, 2026	128	9	33.33%	2	10.53%	11	8.59%	941.09	12.69%
As at March 31, 2025	129	4	15.38%	-	-	4	3.10%	1,001.88	14.94%
As at March 31, 2024	122	5	21.74%	1	5.56%	7	5.74%	1,861.40	35.50%

3. **Revenue and Profitability is directly linked to QAAUM which could decline due to adverse market movements, redemptions:** Any decline in our QAAUM, whether due to market depreciation, investor redemptions, or other factors, directly reduces our management fee income. Investor redemptions in response to poor scheme performance, market volatility, or changes in investor preferences could result in a significant decline in our QAAUM. Large-scale redemptions, particularly by institutional investors or high-net-worth individuals, could create a compounding effect where redemptions force schemes to sell securities at unfavourable prices, resulting in further performance deterioration and additional redemptions.
- The table below sets forth our management fees as a percentage of our total revenue from operations for Fiscal 2026, Fiscal 2025 and Fiscal 2024:

Particulars	For Fiscal 2026	For Fiscal 2025	For Fiscal 2024
Management fees (₹ million) (A)	42,344.92	34,377.87	26,101.82
Total revenue from operations (₹ million) (B)	43,894.88	35,977.57	26,905.58
Management fees as a percentage of total revenue from operations (C=A/B)%	96.47%	95.55%	97.01%

4. **Lower fees on Passive Investment Products:** We face risks relating to the growth of passive investment products, which typically have lower fees and could impact our actively managed QAAUM and reduce our profitability. The table below sets forth our mutual fund QAAUM from passive products (i.e., ETFs and index funds) as at March 31, 2026, March 31, 2025, and March 31, 2024:

Particulars	As at March 31, 2026	As at March 31, 2025	As at March 31, 2024
QAAUM from passive products (ETFs and Index Funds) (₹ billion) (A)	4,055.26	3,416.86	3,182.01
Total Mutual Fund QAAUM* (₹ billion) (B)	12,509.98	10,729.49	9,143.64
QAAUM from passive products as a % of total mutual fund QAAUM (C=A/B)%	32.42%	31.85%	34.80%

5. **Distribution Channel Dependence Risk:** We distribute our mutual fund schemes through multiple channels, including SBI's branch network and YONO banking platform, mutual fund distributors including 132,519 institutional and individual MFDs, which includes 122,460 independent financial advisors, 9,964 national distributors, and 95 banks (including SBI) as of March 31, 2026, digital channels and direct channels including our branches, website and InvesTap mobile application. Any disruption in distribution channels or deterioration in relationships with key distributors could adversely affect our ability to attract and retain investors.
- The table below provides a split of our MAAUM generated from direct and third party distribution channels as at the dates

Continued on next page...

indicated:

6. Scheme Concentration Risk: A portion of our mutual fund QAAUM and revenue from mutual fund operations is concentrated in a limited number of schemes, and any adverse developments affecting these schemes could materially affect our business. As at March 31, 2026, our top 5 schemes by mutual fund QAAUM accounted for 42.57% of our total mutual fund QAAUM and our top 10 schemes by mutual fund QAAUM accounted for 59.47% of our mutual fund QAAUM. Any adverse developments affecting these schemes could have a disproportionate impact on our overall assets under management, revenues, and profitability.

8. We do not own 'SBI' trademark or the "SBI FUNDS" logo, and termination of the SBI Trademark License Agreement with State Bank of India or any inability to use the "SBI" name or the "SBI FUNDS" logo may materially and adversely affect our business, prospects, financial condition, and results of operations.

9. A significant component of our PMS business has historically been derived from our mandate to manage a portion of a statutory provident fund institution in India's corpus, where we have served as a portfolio manager since the inception of its equity investment program. As at March 31, 2026, we held a 49.9% market share of this institution's equity corpus under management (*Source: CRISIL Report*) reflecting the depth of our institutional track record. This fund in India is currently undertaking a comprehensive update of its investment management structure, including appointment of new portfolio managers and asset management companies across its fixed income and exchange traded fund mandates. As part of this process, we have received a reallocation notice under our fixed income mandate, which may result, for the time being, in a material reduction of assets under management in our discretionary PMS business. Any such reallocation may also impact assets under management and mutual fund market share.

11. The Price/Earnings Ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 for the Company at the upper end of the price band is 38.16. The composite Industry peer group Price / Earnings ratio is 41.64.

12. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Financial Years ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 38.77.

13. The average cost of acquisition of Equity Shares for Promoter Selling Shareholders ranges from ₹0.15 per Equity Share to ₹4.35 per Equity Share.

14. Weighted average cost of acquisition of Equity Shares of the Promoters (including the Promoter Selling Shareholders):

As certified by Kirtane & Pandit LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN: 105215W/W-100057), by way of their certificate dated July 10, 2026.

[^]Also the Promoter Selling Shareholder.

**Pursuant to resolution dated November 10, 2025 passed by the Board, and resolution dated December 9, 2025 passed by the Shareholders, the Company undertook a bonus issue of Equity Shares in the ratio of three Equity Shares for every one Equity Share held. Acquisition price of Equity Shares acquired pursuant to such bonus issue is nil.*

As certified by Kirtane & Pandit LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN: 105215W/W-100057), by way of their certificate dated July 10, 2026.

****Pursuant to resolution dated November 10, 2025 passed by our Board, and resolution dated December 9, 2025 passed by our Shareholders, the Company undertook a bonus issue of Equity Shares in the ratio of three Equity Shares for every one Equity Share held. Acquisition price of Equity Shares acquired pursuant to such bonus issue is nil.**

16. Weighted average cost of acquisition, Floor Price and Cap Price:

Since there were no Primary Issuance or Secondary Transactions of equity shares of the Company during the 18 months preceding the date of filing of this advertisement, where either issuance or acquisition/ sale is equal to or more than five per cent of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of the Company (calculated based on the pre-issue capital before such transaction/s and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested), the information has been disclosed for price per share of the Company based on the last five secondary transactions where Promoters Selling Shareholders, the members of the Promoter Group, are a party to the transaction, during the last three years preceding to the date of this advertisement irrespective of the size of the transaction:

Based on primary issuances	Nil	N.A.	N.A.
Based on secondary transactions	1.72	316.72 times	333.58 times

As certified by Kirtane & Pandit LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN: 105215W/W-100057), by way of their certificate dated July 10, 2026.

17. The 9 BRLMs associated with the issue have handled 123 public issues in the past three years out of which 40 issues closed below the issue price on listing date

**Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.*

SEBI Capital Markets Limited ("SBICAPS") is an associate of our Company and State Bank of India, one of the Promoter Selling Shareholders, in terms of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations. Accordingly, in compliance with the proviso to Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, SBICAPS would be involved only in the marketing of the Offer. SBICAPS has signed the due diligence certificate and has been disclosed as a BRLM.

With reference to the Red Herring Prospectus and the abridged prospectus to the Red Herring Prospectus ("**Abridged Prospectus**"), each dated July 8, 2026, filed by SBI Funds Management Limited ("**Company**") with the RoC, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, as applicable, investors may note the following:

1. Two of our Promoters, namely State Bank of India and Amundi India Holding, who are also the Promoter Selling Shareholders, have, pursuant to separate share purchase agreements entered into with each of the transferees set out in the table below, each dated July 9, 2026, transferred an aggregate of 32,752,608 Equity Shares having face value of ₹1 each ("**Sale Shares**"), representing 1.60% of the pre-Offer paid-up Equity Share capital of our Company on a fully diluted basis, to such transferees. The Sale Shares were transferred post the filing of the Red Herring Prospectus and Abridged Prospectus (such transfers, the "**Transfers**"), and the particulars of the Transfers are set out below:

^AFor the purpose of this confirmation, 'connected with' is deemed to mean that there are no common directorships, common key managerial personnel and/or more than 1% equity investment interest.

* Napean Opportunities LLP, PI Opportunities Fund-I and PI Opportunities Fund-II are part of the Premji Invest group. The existing investments by Napean Opportunities LLP, PI Opportunities Fund-I and one of the transferees listed in the table above, namely PI Opportunities Fund-II (collectively, the **"Entities"**) in SBI General Insurance Company Limited, a member of the Promoter Group and a Group Company, exceeds 1% equity investment interest in SBI General Insurance Company Limited. Further, the Entities have appointed a nominee director on the board of directors of SBI General Insurance Company Limited.

Details of the transfers were included in the advertisement dated July 10, 2026, published in all editions of Financial Express and Jansatta and in the Mumbai edition of Navshakti (the “**addendum to the RHP**”).

2. Investors should read this advertisement along with the RHP and the abridged prospectus, filed with the RoC and submitted to SEBI and the Stock Exchanges, the pre-Offer and Price Band advertisement and addendum to the RHP before making an investment decision with respect to the Offer.

Continued on next page..

...continued from previous page.



BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

The "Basis for Offer Price" on page 121 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>, www.axiscapital.co.in, <https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india>, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.motilaloswal.com and www.sbicans.com, respectively for the "Basis for Offer Price" updated for the above.

You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited.

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:			
Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):		Bid/Offer Programme	
Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)		Event	Indicative Date
Submission and Revision in Bids, Eligible SBIFM Employees and Eligible SBI Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible SBI Shareholders Bidding in the SBI Shareholder Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. IST	ANCHOR INVESTOR BID	MONDAY, JULY 13, 2026
		BID/OFFER OPENED ON	TUESDAY, JULY 14, 2026
		BID/OFFER CLOSING ON	THURSDAY, JULY 16, 2026 ⁽ⁱ⁾
		Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about FRIDAY, JULY 17, 2026
Bid/Offer Closing Date		Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about MONDAY, JULY 20, 2026
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) for RIBs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST	Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about MONDAY, JULY 20, 2026
Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is up to ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST	Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about TUESDAY, JULY 21, 2026
⁽ⁱ⁾ UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Bid/Offer Closing Date, i.e. Thursday, July 16, 2026.			
*In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled/ withdrawn/ deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidders shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by the UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which has also prescribed that all individual investors applying in initial public offerings opening on or after May 1, 2022, where the application amount is up to ₹ 0.50 million, shall use UPI. RIBs, Eligible SBIFM Employees and Eligible SBI Employees Bidding under Employee Reservation Portion for up to ₹ 0.50 million (net of Employee Discount, if any), Eligible SBI Shareholders Bidding under SBI Shareholder Reservation Portion for up to ₹ 0.50 million and individual investors Bidding under the Non-Institutional Portion Bidding for more than ₹ 0.20 million and up to ₹ 0.50 million, using the UPI Mechanism, shall provide their UPI ID in the Bid-cum-Application Form for Bidding through Syndicate, sub-syndicate members, Registered Brokers, RTAs or CDPs, or online using the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account (3 in 1 type accounts), provided by certain brokers.			
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories#		Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date	
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs, Eligible SBIFM Employees and Eligible SBI Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible SBI Shareholders Bidding in the SBI Shareholder Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST		
[*] UPI mandate end time shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date			
[#] QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids			
On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:			
(i) 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and			
(ii) until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RIBs, Eligible SBIFM Employees and Eligible SBI Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible SBI Shareholders Bidding in the SBI Shareholder Reservation Portion.			
On Bid/Offer Closing Date, extension of time may be granted by Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received by RIBs after taking into account the total number of Bids received up to closure of timings for acceptance of Bid cum Application Forms as stated herein and as informed to the Stock Exchanges.			

ASBA*

Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues.

No cheque will be accepted.

UPI
UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CDBT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CDBT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Category; (ii) Eligible SBIFM Employees and Eligible SBI Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (net of Employee Discount, if any); (iii) Eligible SBI Shareholders Bidding in the SBI Shareholder Reservation Portion with an application size of up to ₹ 0.50 million; and (iv) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "Offer Procedure" on page 501 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("AIBI") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from a list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited, State Bank of India and Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail ID: ipo_uip@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, the Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and intimation to SCSBs (as defined hereinafter), Designated Intermediaries (as defined hereinafter) and the Sponsor Banks (as defined hereinafter) as applicable.

This is an Offer in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to QIBs (such portion the "QIB Portion") provided that the Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("Anchor Investor Portion"), of which 40% shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% shall be reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the price at which Equity Shares will be allocated to the Anchor Investors ("Anchor Investor Allocation Price"), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any under-subscription in the reserved category specified in clause (ii) above, may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (excluding the Anchor Investor Portion) ("Net QIB Portion"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to NIBs of which (a) one third portion shall be reserved for NIBs with application size of more than ₹ 0.20 million and up to ₹ 1.00 million; and (b) two-thirds of the portion shall be reserved for NIBs with application size of more than ₹ 1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category of NIBs in accordance with SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price and not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to RIBs in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to (i) Eligible SBIFM Employees and Eligible SBI Employees Bidding under the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price (net of Employee Discount, if any); and (iii) Eligible SBI Shareholders Bidding in the SBI Shareholder Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids having been received at or above the Offer Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism (as defined hereinafter)), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see "Offer Procedure" beginning on page 501 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI

mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of the Company as regards its Objects: For information on the main objects of the Company, please see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 275 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of the Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" on page 548 of the RHP.

Liability of the Members of the Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of Share Capital of the Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of the Company is ₹2,100,000,000 Equity Shares divided into 2,100,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up pre-Offer Equity Share capital of the Company is ₹2,036,827,612 divided into 2,036,827,612 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each. For details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 98 of the RHP.

Names of the Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the number of equity shares subscribed by them: The signatories of the Memorandum of Association of the Company are as follows: subscription of one Equity Share each by Dipankar Basu and Ramanathan Viswanathan. For details of the share capital history of the Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 98 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares that will be offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. The Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated May 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus and the Prospectus shall be delivered to the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus till the Bid/Offer Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" on page 548 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of Securities and Exchange Board of India: SEBI only gives its observations on the offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 451 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 460 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to the page 460 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Bidders are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of the Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "Risk Factors" beginning on page 24 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER				
 Kotak Investment Banking Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited 27 BKC, 1st Floor, Plot No. C – 27, "G" Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000 E-mail: sbifml ipo@kotak.com Investor grievance e-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com Contact person: Ganesh Rane SEBI registration no.: INM000008704	 AXIS CAPITAL Axis Capital Limited Axis House, 1st Floor, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183 E-mail: sbifml ipo@axiscap.in Investor grievance e-mail: complaints@axiscap.in Website: www.axiscapital.co.in Contact person: Harish Patel / Tosit Agarwal SEBI registration no.: INM000012029	 BoFA SECURITIES BoFA Securities India Limited Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC "G" Block, Bandra Kurla Complex Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000 E-mail: dg.sbi_fm_ipo@bofa.com Investor grievance e-mail: dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india Contact person: Sneha Ashish SEBI registration no.: INM000011625	 HSBC HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited 52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Mumbai 400 001, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289 E-mail: sbiamcipo@hsbc.co.in Investor grievance e-mail: investor grievance@hsbc.co.in Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in Contact person: Harsh Thakkar / Harshit Tayal SEBI registration no.: INM000010353	 ICICI Securities ICICI Securities Limited ICICI Venture House, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai, 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100 E-mail: sbifml ipo@icicisecurities.com Investor grievance e-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com Website: www.icicisecurities.com Contact person: Ramesh Vaswana / Shri Subramanyam SEBI registration no.: INM000011179
BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER				REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER
 Jefferies Jefferies India Private Limited Level 16, Express Towers, Nariman Point Mumbai 400 021, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000 E-mail: SBI.Funds.Management@jefferies.com Investor Grievance ID: jiji.grievance@jefferies.com Website: www.jefferies.com Contact person: Akshat Shah / Hanu Bansal SEBI registration no.: INM000011443	 JM Financial JM Financial Limited 7th Floor, Chenergy, Appasaheb, Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: sbifm ipo@jmfl.com Investor grievance e-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com Website: www.jmfl.com Contact person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI registration no.: INM000010361	 Motilal Oswal Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimtullah Sayani Road, Opposite Parel ST Depot, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380 E-mail: sbifmipo@motilaloswal.com Investor Grievance e-mail: motiaplredressal@motilaloswal.com Website: www.motilaloswal.com Contact person: Ronak Shah / Shashank Pisat SEBI registration no.: INM000011005	 SBICAPS Complete Investment Banking Solutions SBI Capital Markets Limited* 1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, Parinee Crescenzo Building, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India. Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807 E-mail: sbifm ipo@sbicans.com Investor Grievance e-mail: investor.relations@sbicans.com Website: www.sbicans.com Contact person: Aradhya Rajyaguru / Raghavendra Bhat SEBI registration no.: INM000003531	 KFin Technologies Limited 301, The Centrum, 3rd Floor, 57 Lal Bahadur Shastri Road, Nav Pada, Kurla (West), Kurla, Mumbai 400 070, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 40 67162222/18003094001 E-mail: sbifml ipo@kfintech.com Investor grievance e-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com Contact person: M. Murali Krishna SEBI registration no.: INR000000221
CHIEF COMPLIANCE OFFICER, COMPANY SECRETARY AND HEAD LEGAL				
Vinaya Datar SBI Funds Management Limited 9th Floor, Crescenzo, C – 38 & 39, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India, Telephone: +91 22 6179 3000, E-mail: companysecretary@sbifm.com			Investors may contact the Chief Compliance Officer, Company Secretary and Head Legal, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related problems, such as non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs	

*SBICAPS is an associate of our Company and State Bank of India, one of the Promoter Selling Shareholders, in terms of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations. Accordingly, in compliance with the proviso to Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, SBICAPS would be involved only in the marketing of the Offer. SBICAPS has signed the due diligence certificate and has been disclosed as a BRLM.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP read with the addendum to the RHP and the abridged prospectus dated July 10, 2026 and the "Risk Factors" beginning on page 24 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP will be made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the BRLMs. Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>, Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, BoFA Securities India Limited at <https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india>, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited at www.business.hsbc.co.in, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, Jefferies India Private Limited at www.jefferies.com, JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com and SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicans.com and at the website of the Company, SBI Funds Management Limited at <https://sbifunds.com/investor-relations> and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE at www.bseindia.com and for NSE Limited at www.nseindia.com.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: <https://sbifunds.com/investor-relations>, <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>, www.axiscapital.co.in, <https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india>, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.motilaloswal.com, www.sbicans.com and www.kfintech.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM: Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of the Company, SBI Capital Markets Limited, Tel: +91 22 6179 3000; **BRLMs:** Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Tel: +91 22 4336 0000, Axis Capital Limited, Tel: +91 22 4325 2183, BoFA Securities India Limited, Tel: +91 22 6632 8000, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, Tel: +91 22 6864 1289, ICICI Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6807 7100, Jefferies India Private Limited, Tel: +91 22 4356 6000, JM Financial Limited, Tel: +91 22 6630 3030, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited, Tel: +91 22 7193 4380 and SBI Capital Markets Limited, Tel: +91 22 4006 9807 and **Syndicate Members:** Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited, Tel: +91 22 6849 7400, Kotak Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6218 5410, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Tel: +91 22 7193 4200 / +91 22 7193 4263, JM Financial Services Limited, Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, SBICAP Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, Registered Brokers, SCSBs, Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and at all the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

SBI FUNDS MANAGEMENT LIMITED is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to undertake an initial public offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a red herring prospectus dated July 8, 2026 read with the addendum to the red herring prospectus dated July 10, 2026 ("RHP") along with an abridged prospectus dated July 8, 2026, with the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai-I, Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), BSE Limited ("BSE") and the National Stock Exchange of India ("NSE"), together with "BSE", the "Stock Exchanges", The RHP along with the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e., Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>, Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, BoFA Securities India Limited at <https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india>, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited at www.business.hsbc.co.in, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, Jefferies India Private Limited at www.jefferies.com, JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com and SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicans.com, the website of the NSE at www.nseindia.com and the website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of the Company at <https://sbifunds.com/investor-relations>. Potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk. For details, potential investors should refer to the RHP (read with the addendum to the RHP and the abridged prospectus) and the abridged prospectus which has been filed with the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai-I, including the section titled "Risk Factors". Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP for making any investment decision.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act or any state securities laws in the United States, and may not be offered or sold within the United States or to, or for the account or benefit of, U.S. Persons, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. The Company has not registered and does not intend to register under the U.S. Investment Company Act in reliance on Section 3(c)(7) of the U.S. Investment Company Act, and investors will not be entitled to the benefits of the U.S. Investment Company Act. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are only being offered and sold (i) to persons in the United States or to or for the account or benefit of, U.S. Persons, in each case to investors that are both "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "U.S. QIBs" and, for the avoidance of doubt, the term U.S. QIBs does not refer to a category of institutional investor defined under applicable Indian regulations and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "QIBs") and "qualified purchasers" (as defined under the U.S. Investment Company Act and referred to in the Red Herring Prospectus as "QPs") in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and in reliance on Section 3(c)(7) of the U.S.

Duty-free goods worth \$140 million shipped to UK on Day 1 of trade pact

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

A yellow container crane is lifting a blue container from a truck at a port. The background shows stacks of various colored containers (red, blue, yellow, green) and a clear sky.



Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Healthcare group	Services	PE company	PE country
Fortis Group	36 healthcare facilities	IHH healthcare (31%)	Kuala Lumpur Malaysia
Baby Memorial Hospital	Four hospitals in Kerala	KKR & co (75% controlling stake) with ₹5,100 cr	US
Manipal Hospitals	49 hospitals	Tamasek (59% controlling stake)	Singapore
Care Hospital	15 multispecialty branches across 7 cities in India	Blackstone (72.5% stake)	US
Ujala Cygnus Hospital	25 multi-super specialty hospitals	General Atlantic (75% majority stake)	US
Apollo HealthCo	Digital and pharmacy subsidiary of Apollo Hospitals	Advent International (12% stake) (Invested ₹2,475 cr)	US
Gleneagles Global Health City	Hospital in Chennai	IHH healthcare buy out in 2023	Kuala Lumpur Malaysia

Reuters
London

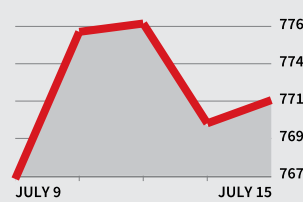
week, fraying an already fragile truce reached in June after several months of fighting. Late on Tuesday, the US military said it had hit dozens of military targets near the strategic waterway and Iranian coastal areas in strikes lasting seven hours.

In response, Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps said on Wednesday it struck US military targets in the region, including in Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan. The US military said its fresh strikes on Wednesday against Iran's coastal defence systems and cruise missile storage and launch sites were "designed to further degrade military capabilities Iranian forces have used to attack commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz".

Analysts have said Iran has been signalling it may use its Houthi allies in Yemen to shut the Bab el-Mandeb gateway to the Red Sea, opening a new front against Washington and putting two of the world's most vital energy arteries at risk. Further strengthening oil prices was a US naval blockade of ships coming and going to Iranian ports, said US analyst Giovanni Staunovo.

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77185.43 (+130.49)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24078.50	+26.45
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.93	+0.04
US Dollar (in ₹)	96.25	+0.05
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	141340.00	+26
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	219711.00	-264

FRESH INVESTMENT.

India-Japan Fund, Hero MotoCorp and Ather founders inject ₹1,200 cr into electric vehicle-maker **p2**



TECHNOPHILE.

OPPO Find X9 Ultra pairs class-leading zoom photography with flagship-grade performance and refinements **p4**

QUICKLY.

HYPERFADES

SpaceX shares slump below IPO price



SpaceX shares slumped to their lowest level since the rocket, satellite and artificial intelligence company went public as investor fanfare quickly evaporated in the month since its trading debut. The stock fell 2 per cent to \$133.34 on Wednesday, breaking below the \$135 per share level that it sold them to investors last month as part of a record \$86 billion offering. **BLOOMBERG**

BOOSTING LENDING PLAY

TVS Venu's Home Credit buys Varthana for ₹967 cr

Bengaluru: TVS Venu's Home Credit India has acquired Varthana Finance in an all-cash deal worth ₹967 crore, expanding its financial services portfolio and strengthening its presence in specialised lending segments. The acquisition complements the group's existing consumer, retail and commercial lending businesses under TVS Credit Services and Home Credit India, while marking its entry into education-focused lending. **p2**

₹1.9-lakh-cr boost for phone manufacturing, chipmaking

CRUCIAL MOVE. Cabinet approves ₹62,500-cr MPMS and ₹1.27-lakh-cr Semicon 2.0

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a new ₹62,500 crore Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme aimed at driving deeper localisation and domestic design in India's high-tech manufacturing sector over the next five years.

Slated to run from financial year 2026-27 through 2030-31, the programme succeeds the Production Linked Incentive Scheme for Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing (PLI-LSEM), which ended on March 31, 2026.

With this revamped framework, the government is targeting a cumulative production of ₹39 lakh crore during its tenure, aiming to transition the country from a volume-based exporter to a high-value technology hub.

The Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, also approved 'Semicon 2.0' for the development of a semiconductor design and manufacturing ecosystem, with a total budget outlay of ₹1.27 lakh crore.



ECONOMIC VALUE. The scheme aims at building Indian brands to achieve technological sovereignty

PLI ISSUES ADDRESSED

Sources said concerns around the previous PLI-LSEM scheme, including its inability to scale up value addition in manufacturing, had been addressed in the new scheme finalised after eight months of consultations with stakeholders, especially the industry.

I&B Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said, "The mobile scheme will be spread over five years, from FY2026-27 to 2030-31. There is a provision to make a mobile phone brand of India. There will be a separate project for Indian mobile phones."

To encourage localisation

of sourcing, which is key to creating an ecosystem, the scheme provides additional incentive of up to 1.5 per cent linked to domestic sourcing of key components and sub-assemblies.

"The scheme also aims at building Indian brands to achieve technological sovereignty, capture large economic value and create Indian patents in design and R&D," a government statement read.

Beyond localising components, the most significant departure from the past is the scheme's focus on building technological sovereignty. To cultivate home

grown global brands and end reliance on foreign product architectures, it introduces an additional 3 per cent incentive on eligible sales for local product design and research and development.

To systematically dismantle the assembly-only model, the new scheme moves away from a flat payout structure. While baseline incentive support is pegged between 2.25 per cent and 5 per cent on incremental sales, the government has introduced a tiered payout mechanism.

SEMICON 2.0

Announcing the ₹1.27 lakh crore 'Semicon 2.0' scheme to holistically build India's semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem, Vaishnaw said it will span the entire value chain across six critical pillars, starting with a heavy focus on the domestic design of indigenous chips.

The six key areas include: chip design, semiconductor equipment and materials, fabrication facilities, advanced packaging and testing, research and development, and talent development.

After 5 years, Finance Ministry likely to table supplementary demand for grants in the Monsoon Session

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

In a first in five years, the Finance Ministry is likely to table the Supplementary Demand for Grants (SDG) during the upcoming Monsoon Session of Parliament, an official source told *businessline*.

Alongside the supplementary spending approvals, the Ministry is also expected to introduce three key Bills for consideration and passage. The last time SDG was introduced during a Monsoon Session was in FY22, a fiscal year that ultimately saw three such supplementary demands.

Since then, the government has typically stuck to a two-SDG schedule, presenting one in the Winter Session and the second in the Budget Session.

FISCAL PRESSURES

However, escalating fiscal pressures, primarily driven by higher expenditure linked to the West Asia conflict and mitigation efforts for a below-normal monsoon, are believed to be the key reasons for reviving a monsoon-session SDG this year.

Depending on the nature of the allocation, these sup-

This move comes amid rising fiscal issues linked to the West Asia conflict and challenges posed by a subpar monsoon

plementary demands can be categorised as token, technical or substantive (cash) grants. For FY27, the total Budget size is pegged at ₹53.47 lakh crore.

However, early fiscal indicators show widening pressure; according to data from the Controller General of Accounts, revenue receipts dipped by over 1 per cent during the first two months of the current fiscal compared to the same period last year. Meanwhile, expenditure surged by over 18 per cent, causing the fiscal deficit to swell by more than 12 times during the period under review.

KEY LEGISLATION

Sources indicated the Finance Ministry is expected to introduce three key pieces of legislation — the Securities Market Code Bill, the Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill, and a Bill to replace the

ordinance that exempted foreign portfolio investors, overseas investors, and the Bank for International Settlements from capital gains tax on interest and trading gains from government securities. Notably, the SMC Bill proposes the establishment of a dedicated ombudsman to streamline and resolve investor grievances.

Beyond investor grievance redress, the Code is designed to ease compliance for regulated market entities and enhance institutional coordination among financial regulators. Once enacted, the Bill, which is being vetted by a Select Committee, will replace three legacy laws — the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act, the SEBI Act of 1992, and the Depositories Act of 1996.

The Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill introduces enabling provisions that will allow companies and limited liability partnerships (LLPs) operating within International Financial Services Centres to conduct transactions and maintain their books of accounts in permitted foreign currencies. Additionally, the Bill establishes a regulatory framework for converting specified trusts into LLPs.

Cyber leak exposes Kudankulam, other Reliance Infra projects' data

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Ransomware group World Leaks recently released files relating to infrastructure projects of Anil Ambani's Reliance Group (Reliance ADAG), most prominently India's largest nuclear power plant at Kudankulam, sources told *businessline*.

The leaked data included blueprints and engineering details of parts of the Kudankulam facility and supplier details. Beyond this, *businessline* confirmed exposed data of other projects such as the Sasan Coal Mine project, Mumbai Metro Line 4, the Bihar-Jharkhand road project, the Pokharan Solar project, and the Krishnapatnam thermal project. While the company did not confirm details on the breached data, it described the ransomware at-



tack as "unsuccessful."

While Reliance ADAG independently confirmed a partial data breach, sources told *businessline* that the files had been floating on the dark web for a couple of weeks.

'BID UNSUCCESSFUL'

"A cyber security incident of an unsuccessful ransomware attack resulting in a partial breach of the company's data hosted on one of the servers of a third-party data centre's storage system (Yotta Data Services) has been reported. No ransomware execution, data loss or lateral movement occurred. The services were

restored successfully. The incident has not impacted the core systems and operations of the company," said Reliance ADAG in a stock exchange disclosure on July 7.

Yotta, which provides third party data centre services to Reliance Infrastructure, said it detected and managed endpoint security controls on May 29, against suspicious activity on a server hosted for Reliance Infrastructure. "We acted immediately; the suspicious process was terminated, and the affected server was isolated, preventing the suspected ransomware from executing," a spokesperson said.

Reliance Infrastructure directed Yotta to probe the matter, while Yotta confirmed enhanced measures were in place. For now, the incident has been reported to CERT-In.

With inputs from Avinash Nair in Ahmedabad

CAFE-2 norms: TaMo opposes BEE proposal to sell carbon credits

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles has formally objected to the Bureau of Energy Efficiency's (BEE) proposed compliance credit mechanism under the CAFE-2 regulations. The automaker has urged the government to abandon the provision allowing the regulatory body to directly issue and sell carbon credits to non-compliant manufacturers.

NEUTRAL NO MORE

Tata Motors argued that by stepping into the market as a seller, BEE would compromise its neutral status as an independent administrator and disrupt fair price discovery, sources quoting the automaker's submissions told *businessline*.

Further, the proposed mechanism would permit

defaulting carmakers to purchase credits at a heavily discounted administrative rate, effectively bypassing statutory penalties and diluting the incentive to invest in cleaner technologies.

The submissions came after the BEE, under the Ministry of Power, invited 18 original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) to send suggestions or objections related to such amendments to the Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE-2) norms.

BEE made public the draft amendments on Wednesday proposing to give OEMs the option to purchase credits from it at ₹2,500 per g CO₂/km for each reporting period from financial year 2022-23 to 2026-27.

In its response to Power Secretary Pankaj Agrawal, Tata Motors said, "BEE should regulate, verify and administer the credit-debit mechanism, but should not

itself become a seller of credits in that market. Credits should represent actual, measurable and verified over compliance, and should not be created administratively in unlimited quantities merely upon payment."

CREDIT PRICING

Also, the credit pricing mechanism should be such that non-compliance is not made cheaper than compliance, it said.

Tata Motors said such a step raises a fundamental design concern that is institutional and structural in nature. "A credit market can command confidence only if the regulator remains visibly neutral... If BEE itself supplies credits, it would become, at the same time, the regulator, the market administrator, the price-setter and a counter-party in the very market that it supervises," it said.

Scan to View the Financial Results	Stop the Queue. Scan to Apply	NextGen Banking App		यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया A Government of India Undertaking	Digital Rupee by RBI	Green Rupee
Head Office: 239, Vidhan Bhavan Marg, Nariman Point, Mumbai 400 021 Website: www.unionbankofindia.bank.in						
SERVING THE NATION FOR 107 YEARS						
Powering your Ambitions						
Global Dreams. Indian Trust.						
UBI UNIQUE FCNR (B) SCHEME Tenure : 3-5 years Hurry! Limited period Offer.						
Interest Rate @ 7.15% p.a.						
Super Senior Citizens Senior Citizens General Citizens						
555 Days Deposit for Happiness, Unlimited.						
7.40% p.a. 7.15% p.a. 6.65% p.a.						
SB (YoY Increase) 12.51% RTD (YoY Increase) 12.48% CASA % Domestic (YoY Increase) 258 BPS Gross Advances Domestic (YoY Increase) 13.11% RAM Advances (YoY Increase) 11.56%						
Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026						
₹ in Lakh						
Slippages (YoY Decrease) 8.04%	CET % (YoY Increase) 108 BPS					
GNPA Ratio (YoY Decrease) 87 BPS	CRAR % Q1 Vs Q4 (QoQ Increase) 36 BPS					
NNPA Ratio (YoY Decrease) 15 BPS	Return on Equity % (YoY Increase) 208 BPS					
Credit Cost % (YoY Decrease) 9 BPS	MSME Advances (YoY Growth) 16.49%					
Cost to Income Ratio (QoQ Decrease) 97 BPS	PCR (YoY Increase) 40 BPS					
NOTES: a) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and on the Bank's website (www.unionbankofindia.bank.in). b) For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges (BSE and NSE) and can be accessed on www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com						
For and on behalf of Board of Directors						
Place: Mumbai Date: 15-07-2026	Sd/- Amresh Prasad Executive Director	Sd/- Ramasubramanian S Executive Director	Sd/- Nitesh Ranjan Executive Director	Sd/- Asheesh Pandey Managing Director & CEO		
(Toll Free No.) 1800 2333 / 1800 208 2244 / 1800 425 1515 / 1800 425 3555 9666606060 www.unionbankofindia.bank.in						
Follow us on: unionbankofindia UnionBankTweets unionbankinsta UnionBankofIndiaUtube unionbankofindia unionbankinsta						

Hero MotoCorp, IJF, founders infuse ₹1,200 cr in Ather Energy

POST ALLOTMENT. Hero MotoCorp’s stake will be 30.68%, while IJF’s will rise to 6.02%

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Electric two-wheeler maker Ather Energy has approved a ₹1,200-crore preferential allotment to Hero MotoCorp, the India-Japan Fund (IJF) and its founders, marking the first tranche of its ongoing ₹2,500-crore capital-raise to fund growth, research and development, manufacturing expansion and new product development.

Under the board-approved proposal, Hero MotoCorp will invest ₹960 crore through the subscription of 7.62 crore convertible warrants, while the IJF, managed by the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF), will invest ₹200 crore by subscribing to 16.26 lakh equity shares.

Co-founders Tarun Mehta and Swapnil Jain will each invest ₹20 crore through con-



NEXT STEP. Ather Energy said it will convene an extraordinary general meeting to seek shareholder approval for the preferential issue REUTERS

vertible warrants.

The preferential issue, subject to shareholder approval, is part of Ather’s previously announced ₹2,500-crore Qualified Institutional Placement (QIP), through which the company is looking to strengthen its balance sheet following its public listing earlier this year.

Following the allotment and assuming full conversion of the warrants, Hero MotoCorp’s stake in Ather

will increase from 29.48 per cent to 30.68 per cent on a fully-diluted basis. The IJF’s holding will rise from 5.75 per cent to 6.02 per cent, while the shareholding of the two founders will remain broadly stable due to dilution from the fresh issuance.

MORE INVESTMENTS
The fresh capital comes at a time when Ather is stepping up investments in product development, expanding its

manufacturing capabilities and strengthening its research and development efforts amid intensifying competition in India’s electric two-wheeler market. The company has been broadening its product portfolio beyond the premium segment while investing in charging infrastructure and software capabilities.

The company said it will convene an extraordinary general meeting to seek shareholder approval for the preferential issue.

On June 12, the board of directors of Ather Energy approved a fund-raise of up to ₹2,500 crore. As per a stock exchange disclosure, the proposed fund-raise would be split into two parts — ₹1,500 crore via the QIP route and the balance via a preferential issue, rights issue or any other means. The firm added that it had constituted a fund-raise committee too.

TVS Venu’s Home Credit India acquires Varthana for ₹967 crore to deepen lending play

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

TVS Venu’s Home Credit India has acquired Varthana Finance in an all-cash deal worth ₹967 crore, expanding its financial services portfolio and strengthening its presence in specialised lending segments.

The acquisition complements the group’s existing consumer, retail and commercial lending businesses under TVS Credit Services and Home Credit India, while marking its entry into

education-focused lending. By adding Varthana’s specialised education finance franchise, TVS Venu will expand its presence in secured, longer-tenure lending and diversify its overall loan portfolio.

The group said the acquisition aligns with its long-term strategy of building and scaling high-quality financial services businesses that cater to India’s evolving credit needs across customer segments. It also expects to leverage synergies across distribution, technology, operations and risk manage-

ment through the wider TVS Venu ecosystem.

CREDIT ACCESS
Founded in 2013, Varthana has served more than 13,000 schools across India through education-focused financing. It said many underserved schools continue to require capital to expand infrastructure and improve access to quality education.

Backed by TVS Venu, it expects to expand its reach, offer better financing terms and further its mission of transforming affordable education in the country.

Commenting on the acquisition, Sudarshan Venu, Chairman, TVS Motor Company, said, “India’s financial services sector continues to offer significant opportunities for long-term growth, driven by rising formalisation, expanding credit access and the increasing need for specialised lending solutions.”

Subject to regulatory clearances, including approval from the RBI, the transaction is expected to close after the fulfilment of customary closing conditions.

TVS ILP launches app for warehousing operations

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Industrial & Logistics Parks (TVS ILP), a Grade-A warehouse and industrial infrastructure, has launched ONE TVS ILP, AI-driven Operations and Business Development app to enhance client experience and improve operational efficiency.

The app features ‘Ask-Me’ intelligence to ensure quick turnaround times for service requests, grievance management and value-added services through a single digital interface. It also provides seamless access to real-time onsite information, space availability and other critical operational insights, enabling clients to quickly evaluate options and make informed decisions, said a release.

ONE TVS ILP app follows a unique Voice First approach, allowing users to interact while managing their business needs. By learning from user inputs, preferences and interaction his-

The app features ‘Ask-Me’ intelligence to ensure quick turnaround times for service requests

tory, it delivers contextual suggestions and predictive responses for a more intuitive experience. This facilitates informed decision-making by bringing clarity to every interaction. It also helps anticipate stakeholder considerations, leading to balanced and strategic recommendations, the release said.

The app continues to support customers throughout their lease tenure. Built on a one-click service model with 24x7 assistance, it enables clients to raise service requests for facility-related concerns or maintenance requirements. Once a request is noted, it records the issue, assists the user and alerts the support team, the release said.

June passenger vehicle sales up 24.1%: SIAM

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Domestic passenger vehicle (PV) sales rose 24.1 per cent year-on-year in June, driven by robust demand across vehicle segments, particularly scooters and utility vehicles, according to data released by the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM). The data showed that PV sales increased to 3,88,144 units in June from 3,12,851 units in the year-ago period.

Three-wheeler sales increased 26.1 per cent to 77,951 units (61,828 units), led by passenger carriers, whose sales rose 25.0 per cent to 64,181 units, while sales of goods carriers saw a 29.4 per cent increase to 11,828 units. E-rickshaw sales climbed 52.4 per cent to 1,590 units and e-cart sales rose 19.7 per cent to 352 units. In the two-wheeler segment, domestic sales increased 18.6 per cent to 18,51,400 units (15,61,283 units).

Segment wise, scooter sales recorded the strongest

Robust demand			
Category	Domestic sales (in units)		
	2025	June 2026	% change
Total passenger vehicles	3,12,851	3,88,144	24.10
Three-wheelers			
Passenger carrier	51,350	64,181	25.00
Goods carrier	9,141	11,828	29.40
Total three-wheelers	61,828	77,951	26.10
Two-wheelers			
Scooters	5,35,307	7,44,823	39.10
Motorcycles	9,92,627	10,56,422	6.40
Total two-wheelers	15,61,283	18,51,400	18.60

Source: SIAM; Data does not include detailed passenger vehicle break-up for Tata Motors, sales figures of BMW, Mercedes-Benz, Jaguar Land Rover and Volvo Auto. Tata Motors’ domestic sales have been included in the overall passenger vehicle total

growth among major two-wheeler categories, rising 39.1 per cent to 7,44,823 units. Motorcycle sales increased 6.4 per cent to 10,56,422 units, while moped sales surged 50.4 per cent to 50,155 units.

Q1 SALES
For Q1 FY27 (April-June), data showed that domestic PV sales increased 25.9 per cent to 12,73,811 units (10,11,884 units). Two-wheeler sales increased 20.3 per cent to 56,28,675 units (46,77,990 units). Commercial vehicle sales rose 18.3

ODI flows to GCC nations surge as war raises funding needs of overseas subsidiaries

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

At a time when the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) nations come under the impact of the US-Iran war, Indian companies sharply increased outward foreign investments into the region, particularly to the UAE.

DATA FOCUS.

However, instead of fresh equity for new ventures, the overseas direct investments (ODIs) were primarily through loans and guarantees to their subsidiaries, suggesting support to existing overseas subsidiaries or projects rather than setting up entirely new ventures.

Overseas investment commitments into the GCC countries comprising Bahrain, Qatar, Oman, Saudi Arabia and the UAE, rose 51 per cent year-on-year to \$1.9 billion since the time the war commenced — during March-May 2026. This was up from \$1.2 billion in the same period last year, as per RBI data.

This comes at a time when the overall growth of ODI from India has been about 18 per cent in the same post-war period.

India’s total ODI in March-May 2026 stood at \$18.4 billion, higher than \$15.5 billion in the same period of 2025.

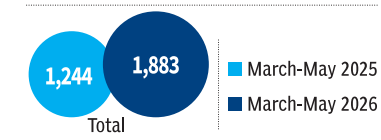
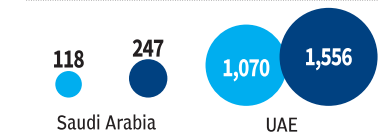
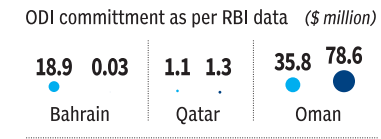
Of the \$1.9 billion invested in the GCC countries, the UAE alone accounted for \$1.6 billion with India Inc having close business ties with the region.

However, the increase is being driven less by equity infusion and more by loans and guarantees.

ODI FLOW
A detailed look at the kind of ODIs showed that the UAE investments were 57 per cent in the form of guarantee commitments, 26 per cent

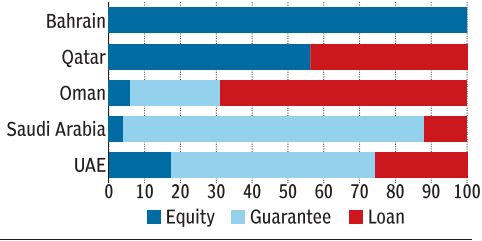
The West Asia war impact

Overseas direct investments in GCC nations is up 51 per cent



Majority of this ODI is flowing as loans and guarantees rather than equity

Share of equity, guarantee and loan commitment in ODI in March-May 2026 – in %



Total ODI in CY26 (till May) is marginally up from last year

ODI commitment in Jan-May

2025	22.8	2026	25
------	------	------	----

Top ODI during March-May 2026

Month	Company	Recipient company	Towards	Recipient country	\$ million
March	Tata Motors	TML CV Holdings Pte.	WOS	Singapore	2,263
April	Coforge	Encora Holdings	JV	Cayman Islands	1,371
April	Coforge	Encora US Holdco, Inc.	WOS	US	994
May	Samvardhana Motherson Intl	MSSL Mauritius Holdings	WOS	Mauritius	884
May	Indovida India	Indovida Netherlands B.V.	WOS	Netherlands	673
March	ReNew	ReNew Treasury IFSC	WOS	IFSC GIFT City	660
April	Adani Transmission Step-One	ATSOL Global IFSC	WOS	IFSC GIFT City	600
March	Jindal Power	Jindal Steel & Power (Mauritius)	WOS	Mauritius	578
March	Rollta India	Rollta International Inc.	WOS	US	450
March	Tata Steel	T Steel Holdings Pte.	WOS	Singapore	444
WOS - wholly-owned subsidiary					

Source: RBI

loans and only 17 per cent equity.

This was more pronounced in Oman, with nearly 69 per cent loans and just 25 per cent guarantee. Similarly, 84 per cent of ODI sent to Saudi Arabia was in the form of guarantees to subsidiaries.

ODI is a decision taken by private players based on the fund infusion needed for either new JV or projects globally or goes towards supporting existing subsidiaries, Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, said.

“The increase in ODI to the GCC nations on a year-

on-year basis could indicate Indian companies taking care of the likely stress in West Asia operations by supporting subsidiaries there,” he added.

Among the top ODI into the GCC nations included Reliance Industries’ \$250-million guarantee to its UAE entity in March.

Llyods Metals and Energies also committed \$210 million ODI in the form of loans and guarantees to Lloyds Global Resources, its UAE subsidiary.

Acme Global Green Hydrogen also made an ODI commitment of a loan of \$28

million to its Oman entity Green Hydrogen and Chemicals SAOC. Man Industries, which makes steel pipes, made a \$140 million guarantee to Man International Steel Industries Company (MISIC), its wholly-owned subsidiary in Saudi Arabia.

Overall, India’s ODI continues to be driven by a handful of large corporate investments.

Tata Motors’ \$2.3 billion ODI to Singapore holding entity and Coforge’s \$2.3 billion towards its acquisition of Encora emerged top ODIs in the March-May 2026 window.

Omega Seiki Mobility seeks ₹125 cr in pre-IPO funding to fuel EV expansion

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Faridabad-based Omega Seiki Mobility (OSM), maker of the Rage+ cargo electric three-wheeler (e3W) and Stream City passenger electric three-wheeler (e3W), is evaluating a public listing while seeking to raise around ₹125 crore through a pre-IPO funding round, according to people familiar with the matter.

The company is targeting an IPO by the end of the next financial year, while the current funding round is expected to be completed by the end of this quarter.

The proposed fund-raise will finance expansion across the company’s electric two-, three- and four-wheeler businesses, strengthen manufacturing capacity, expand exports and support research and development, particularly for its larger electric truck platform.

Confirming that the company is evaluating capital-raising options, OSM Chairman and Founder Uday Narang declined to comment on the specifics of the proposed transaction. “We are evaluating all options. The company needs capital and we are looking at what is best for the long-term growth of the company,” he told *businessline*.

People familiar with the discussions said the management is confident of closing the current funding round by the end of the current quarter.

SCALING BUSINESS

A significant part of the proceeds is expected to be deployed towards expanding OSM’s passenger e3W business, which Narang described as the company’s “bread and butter.”

OSM currently sells around 600-700 e3Ws a month and believes volumes could double or even triple as it expands production, strengthens distribution and



Uday Narang, Chairman and Founder, Omega Seiki Mobility

improves working capital.

The company also plans to widen its dealer network, improve utilisation of its existing manufacturing facilities in Pune and Faridabad, accelerate overseas expansion and invest further in developing its electric two-wheelers, three-wheelers and M1KA range of larger electric trucks.

Although OSM has developed a one-tonne electric truck, Narang said the company would scale the business only when the economics become more favourable.

BEFORE FUNDRAISING

OSM closed FY26 with revenue of around ₹330 crore and expects to cross ₹450 crore in FY27.

Unlike many EV start-ups that relied on successive venture capital funding rounds, OSM has largely financed its growth through promoter capital, with Japan’s Exedy Corporation remaining its only strategic investor. “We wanted to build a sustainable business. The ₹450-crore revenue target is very achievable in FY27,” Narang said.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser’s products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

Dell unveils AI-ready Pro Precision workstations

Dell Technologies unveiled its new Dell Pro Precision portfolio in India, a line-up of AI-ready workstations designed for



professionals who demand high performance. The all-new Dell Pro Precision brings greater capabilities for AI workloads, complex simulations and

advanced rendering directly to the desk. This line-up includes the Dell Pro Precision 5 series (14S,16S), Dell Pro Precision 5 series (14,16), Dell Pro Precision 7 series (14,16) and the Dell Pro Precision 7 T1.

One of the showstoppers at the launch was the Dell Pro Precision 5 series 14S that weighs 1.4 kg and is Dell's thinnest and lightest workstation ever and the thinnest entry mobile workstation with the latest H-class processors. It features a sleek three-sided aluminium design, providing a polished, robust build. Available with 14-inch and 16-inch display options and Intel Core Ultra Series 3 with integrated Intel Arc Pro graphics (up to 12 Xe) or AMD Ryzen AI 400 processors with AMD Radeon PRO graphics, it delivers high performance for business and industry applications in an ultra-mobile form factor.

Nothing Phone (4b) now on sale in India

Nothing's Phone (4b), the first smartphone in the company's new (b) series, is now available in India through Flipkart and retail partners



including Croma, Reliance Digital and Vijay Sales. Positioned as an entry-level device in the Nothing ecosystem, the Phone (4b) features the Snapdragon 6 Gen 4

processor, a 6.77-inch 120Hz Super AMOLED display with up to 2,000 nits peak brightness, a 6,000 mAh battery with 33 W fast charging support and a 50 MP primary camera with OIS powered by Nothing's TrueLens Engine 4.

The smartphone retains Nothing's signature transparent design and Glyph Interface and runs Nothing OS 4.1 based on Android 16. The software includes the company's essential AI features and is backed by three years of Android OS updates and six years of security updates.

Available in Black, White and Blue, the Phone (4b) comes in 8 GB +128 GB and 8 GB + 256 GB variants, priced at an effective ₹29,999 and ₹33,999.

realme unveils Narzo 100x 5G with 8,000mAh battery

realme has unveiled the Narzo 100x 5G, a mid-range smartphone featuring an 8,000 mAh battery, 45 W fast charging and the



MediaTek Dimensity 6300 processor. The device sports a 6.8-inch LCD display with a 144 Hz refresh rate and up to 1,200 nits peak brightness. Powered by the 6 nm

Dimensity 6300 octa-core chipset, the smartphone supports up to 14 GB dynamic RAM and 256 GB storage. It runs on realme UI 7.0 and includes AI-powered features such as AI Eraser, AI Portrait Lighting, an AI Notes assistant and Gemini Live integration.

For photography, the Narzo 100x 5G features a 50 MP dual rear camera setup and an 8 MP front-facing camera. It is equipped with battery management features including bypass charging, AI night charging and AI cold charging. Realme claims the battery is designed to retain over 80 per cent of its capacity after 1,600 charge cycles.

The device comes with MIL-STD-810H certification, IP65-rated dust and water resistance, and will be offered in Midnight Black and Flash Orange colour options.

It will be available from July 22 , with prices starting at ₹18,499.

OpenAI unveils ChatGPT Work, GPT-5.6 model family

OpenAI has unveiled ChatGPT Work, a new AI agent designed to carry out multi-step tasks across connected applications, files and workflows.



Powered by the new GPT-5.6 model family, the tool can gather context from selected apps and data sources to create outputs such as documents,

spreadsheets, presentations and web applications.

The launch also brings together Chat, Work and Codex within a unified ChatGPT desktop app. While Chat remains focused on general assistance, Work is aimed at longer and more complex projects and Codex targets developers and technical users.

Alongside the new agent, OpenAI announced the GPT-5.6 family, comprising Sol, Terra and Luna. Sol is positioned as the flagship model for advanced reasoning, coding, cybersecurity and research tasks, while Terra is designed for general-purpose use and Luna for cost-efficient deployments. OpenAI said the new models improve multi-step reasoning, template-based content creation and output quality across documents, presentations and spreadsheets. The rollout has begun globally.

Ashwin Rajagopalan

There's no denying that flagship smartphones are now in the 'iterative' upgrade phase. We're not seeing those huge year-on-year upgrades at a time when we seem to have hit the peak with smartphone experiences. However, there's one area where brands continue to push the boundaries, leveraging partnerships with imaging companies. The Opps Find X9 Ultra has upped the stakes in the fight for the best smartphone camera of the year. It's a tough contest with devices such as the Vivo X300 Ultra (with Zeiss optics) and the iPhone 17 Pro series with its stellar video capabilities. Does the X9 Ultra have enough tricks up its sleeve for this show-down? We dive straight in.

CAMERA

If there's one reason the X9 Ultra deserves your attention, it's the camera. It's easily one of the best mobile shooters we've tested all year. The X9 Ultra becomes the first Ultra device from Oppo to arrive in India. Previous editions have remained restricted to markets such as China. Comparisons with the Vivo X300 Ultra are inevitable. Unlike Vivo, OPPO has opted to launch the X9 Ultra without the extender kit and is betting big on its twin zoom lenses.

The five-sensor rear camera array is one of the most formidable we've seen on any smartphone camera. It combines a 200 MP main camera (ƒ/1.5 aperture), a 200 MP 3x telephoto lens, a 50 MP 10x optical periscope lens, a 50 MP ultrawide camera and a multispectral/true colour sensor. It's not just impressive on paper but truly shines in real life scenarios too. I aimed for the moon almost as soon as I unboxed this device, and the super zoom was quite impressive. The X9 Ultra benefits from Hasselblad's colour science, producing terrific images in almost every scenario. It's these colours that set the camera apart from its rivals.

While I don't mind shooting occasionally in pro mode, tweaking the settings for every shot, I am like most users who want to capture the moment in an instant. The settings on the Find X9 Ultra can be a steep learning curve for everyday users who just want the best images for their social feeds, but it's truly worth the effort. Portrait images are sharp, and low light images are not noisy. This is not just one of the best smartphone cameras you can buy right now but also one of the most versatile.

DESIGN

If Oppo's design intent was to craft a smartphone that resembles a camera, the Find X9 Ultra nails it. I used the Tundra Umber colour option



RUGGED ELEGANCE. The Tundra Umber colour option with a vegan leather finish doesn't just look premium but also feels durable ASHWIN RAJAGOPALAN



The X9 ultra captures great details in low light and benefits from Hasselblad's colour science, producing terrific images



with a vegan leather finish. It doesn't just look premium but also feels durable. I never used the back cover opting to show off the elegant leather finish in a deep shade of grey. The device is also available in the Canyon Orange colour way crafted with aircraft-grade fibre. The most striking design element is the large Hasselblad camera module with a very visible camera bump; we've seen similar iterations on previous Oppo devices. The dedicated camera button (with an orange accent) on the right spine, is very handy. At 236 g, it's certainly one of the heavier flagships; it's 9.1 mm thick, not surprising given the camera set-up. The Find X9 Ultra is one of the best designed smartphones we've tested from the Oppo stable.

DISPLAY

The 6.82-inch LTPO AMOLED display

(4168 x 1440 pixels / 510 PPI) is in the premium flagship class. The display maxes out at 144 Hz refresh rate and hits a peak brightness of 3600 nits. Colours are punchy; visibility is excellent even under direct sunlight. I edited quite a few photos on this device and the colour reproduction is quite impressive. It's a great display to catch videos on the go. I watched two episodes of the Netflix espionage thriller *Unfamiliar* on a flight; the Find X9 Ultra captured night scenes from Berlin's streets and the vivid colours of a street market in Morocco with equal ease.

PERFORMANCE

You expect the best hardware spec sheet at this price, and Oppo doesn't disappoint. At its heart is the best of breed Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 chipset with 12 GB of RAM and 512 GB of internal

storage. The X9 Ultra aced all our tests, consistently notching up scores above 10,600 in our Geekbench (multi-core) benchmark test. This device is ready for anything you throw at it. The smartphone is powered by Color OS 16.0 built on Android 16. Oppo's custom UI has got better over the years with a clean user interface that's visually pleasing and offers multiple customisation options. Oppo offers five years of Android OS updates; this is an area where rivals such as Samsung and Google (with 7 years of OS updates) have an edge. Battery life is a big win for the Find X9 Ultra. The 7050 mAh battery is robust; I never reached out for the charger even on long days with extensive camera usage. Oppo bundles a 100 W supervooc charger in the box that powers this device in less than an hour.

A flagship built for the c-suite that travels light

ASUS EXPERTBOOK ULTRA. With a class-leading OLED display, the ExpertBook Ultra is one of the most sleek enterprise laptops today

Siddharth Mathew Cherian

Asus's presence in the enterprise notebook segment has long been established through its ExpertBook Series. Year after year, the updates have been incremental yet consistently add meaningful improvements for the enterprise community. The latest flagship in the ExpertBook line-up — the ExpertBook Ultra — was recently up for review, and here is my detailed take on the device.

DESIGN

Sleekness is what defines the ExpertBook Ultra in one word. The Asus ExpertBook Ultra is impressively lightweight, starting at just 1 kg. Its compact footprint — 12.24 x 8.38 x 0.43 to 0.65 inches — makes it exceptionally portable, fitting easily into slim backpacks or briefcases.

Despite its thin profile, the chassis feels sturdy and premium, reflecting Asus's commitment to durability and professional design. This balance of portability and build quality makes the ExpertBook Ultra a compelling choice for frequent travellers and executives who need power without the bulk.

DISPLAY

The laptop's display is a standout feature. It offers a 14-inch WQXGA+ (2880x1800) OLED panel in two configurations — a tandem OLED with up to 600 nits brightness (1400 nits HDR peak) or a standard OLED with 450 nits of brightness (1000 nits HDR peak). Both versions are Pantone Validated, support 100 per cent DCI-P3 colour gamut, and feature Corning Gorilla Glass Victus with a matte finish for durability and reduced glare. The 91 per cent screen-to-body ratio ensures an immersive viewing experience.

The screen has zero to no screen flex, making it easy to open the laptop lid with one finger. Watching *The Rest Is Football* talk show on Netflix with Gary Lineker, Alan



TRAVEL READY. The Asus ExpertBook Ultra is impressively lightweight, starting at just 1 kg. Its compact footprint — 12.24 x 8.38 x 0.43 to 0.65 inches — makes it exceptionally portable BIJOY GHOSH



Shearer and Micah Richards was an interesting premise test for the laptop. Interestingly, the tandem OLED gets contrast right; however, while watching *The Witcher*, the characteristic of tandem OLED paired with a matte display tends to shift deep blacks towards deep greys, which is very subtle and not noticeable to regular users. Still, the display is the best implementation of tandem OLED so far, before next year's rumoured MacBooks with tandem OLED.

The colour of the unit I reviewed was 'morn grey', which was an ideal colour around the monochrome cubicle spaces in the office. There is a small light strip on the bottom side of the display panel that lights up when switching on, shutting down and more.

SOUND

Audio performance is impressive, featuring six built-in speakers and Dolby Atmos support, complemented by an array microphone for clear voice capture. The sound from the two top firing speakers and two downward tweeters on the laptop secretly makes this laptop a great post work laptop to listen to music.

Additionally, when paired with the tandem OLED screen, it is a match made in heaven. The soundstage was quite encompassing, and

fine details in the instruments were evident in AR Rehman's *Deewana Deewana* from *Tere Ishq Mein*. The loudness was good but not great; however, the speakers delivered good output at full volume without breaking.

KEYBOARD AND PORTS

Connectivity is robust, featuring two Thunderbolt 4 ports supporting USB4, display output and power delivery (one on each side), alongside two USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-A ports, an HDMI 2.1 port and a 3.5 mm audio jack. Expansion is supported via one M.2 2280 PCIe 4.0 slot. There is also a USB-Ethernet dongle included in the box for secure corporate ethernet connectivity. The keyboard offers 1.5 mm key travel for comfortable typing, paired with a haptic touchpad that enhances precision.

The keys gave a good amount of tactility and felt quite tactile while typing long reviews. The glass trackpad comes close to the MacBook and at times felt a little too sensitive but has a good amount of trackpad rejection to make up for it. The keyboard backlight has three levels and supports well some short sprints of writing sessions at night.

PERFORMANCE

Powering the ExpertBook is the Intel Core Ultra X7 358H, featuring

16 cores and 16 threads with speeds up to 4.8 GHz, paired with 64 GB RAM and 2 TB SSD. Both variants include the Intel AI Boost NPU, delivering up to 50 TOPS of AI performance for accelerated computing and intelligent workloads. Graphics are handled by either the Intel Arc B390 or integrated Intel Graphics, ensuring smooth visuals for creative and professional tasks.

In synthetic Benchmarks, the ExpertBook scored 449 on CPU Single threads and 2484 on multithreads, placing it around 9th place after the Apple M2 chip and the Intel Core Ultra 9 288V. This performance makes it a great machine for office applications and AI applications using the 64 GB RAM to boot.

Pre-installed software includes MyAsus and Asus MyExpert. MyAsus provides tools like Link to MyAsus, WiFi SmartConnect and Battery Health Charging, while MyExpert adds productivity features such as File Search, ExpertMeet, and Knowledge Hub.

In terms of Security, the Expertbook is packed to the brim with enterprise level security in the form of Asus ExpertGuardian with NIST SP 800-193 compliance, TPM 2.0, Microsoft Secured-core PC and Pluton Security Processor. Additional protections include Intel Boot Guard, BIOS Guard, firmware



Early morning shot



Colour reproduction is one of the strong points



In the Super Zoom mode

VERDICT

The Oppo Find X9 Ultra is one of our favourite Android flagships of 2026. It certainly doesn't come cheap but offers a top class camera experience that will please serious camera buffs. It has one of the best zoom photography experiences on any smartphone. The X9 Ultra also ticks all the flagship boxes with an immersive display and a dependable battery, making it easy to recommend for users looking at a top of the line Android smartphone.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹1,69,999
Pros: Camera performance, battery life, vibrant display
Cons: Five years of Android OS upgrades, pricey

resilience and self-recovery mechanisms. Biometric authentication is supported via both IR webcam and fingerprint sensor.

BATTERY

Battery life is powered by a 70 Wh 4-cell Li-ion pack, designed for longevity and efficiency. Charging is handled through a 90 W USB-C adapter, supporting universal voltage input.

The laptop was easily able to handle 8-10 hours of light work like browsing, document work and listening to music. With slightly heavier workloads like AI calculations and a bit of light gaming, it lasts around 2 to 2.5 hours under sustained AI workload and the occasional light gaming.

VERDICT

The ExpertBook Ultra is the best refinement of the ExpertBook series over the year and demands a premium for the audience that it is meant for—C-Suite and corporate power users, with a great display, good performance and great specs to boot. The ExpertBook Ultra falls in the same class as the Apple MacBook Pro, Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook X and Dell XPS 14. The high price, somewhat average battery and the matte display, which feels sort of grainy for non-enterprise customers, notwithstanding, if you are in the market for a premium enterprise laptop, then the ExpertBook Ultra is one of the best choices out there.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹2,39,990 onwards
Pros: Ultra-light premium design, excellent tandem OLED display, powerful enterprise-grade performance and security
Cons: Expensive, average battery under heavy loads, matte finish slightly mutes crisp black

QUICKLY.

SC to hear Jindal Poly
Films investors' plea



Mumbai: The Supreme Court on Friday will hear the plea filed by a group of 29 minority shareholders seeking the recall of its order referring the Jindal Poly Films class-action dispute to arbitration. On Wednesday, senior advocate Kapil Sibal mentioned the class-action matter against Jindal Poly Films before the Chief Justice of India on behalf of the minority public shareholders of Jindal Poly Films. Sibal sought the court's intervention into how a pending class action (an *in rem* proceeding admitted before the NCLT) came to an abrupt halt by way of a settlement by one sole shareholder with the company. It was submitted that the dispute was referred to arbitration during the summer vacation without other shareholders being informed. **OUR BUREAU**

‘Wipro’s next phase of enterprise transformation will be led by AI’

ROAD AHEAD. To invest in platforms, partnerships, talent even as IT industry remains cautious: Chairman

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Wipro will sharpen its focus on AI-led transformation, enterprise platforms and consulting as clients move from experimentation to execution, said Chairman Rishad Premji at the company's 80th annual general meeting (AGM) on Wednesday.

INDUSTRY ‘CAUTIOUS’
The company said it will continue to invest in AI capabilities, platforms, partnerships and talent while maintaining its focus on margins and cash generation even as the broader IT industry remains cautious. Highlighting the changing enterprise technology landscape, Premji said AI represented “a fundamental shift of our time”, and was creating new opportunities for innovation, transformation and

Alongside efficiency gains, AI is creating new opportunities for innovation, transformation and growth

RISHAD PREMJI
Chairman, Wipro



growth. “We believe AI represents a fundamental shift of our time. Alongside efficiency gains, it is creating new opportunities for innovation, transformation and growth while accelerating demand in areas such as data, modernisation and AI-powered IT. Our clients have moved beyond pilots and begun embedding AI into core business processes and operations,” he said. For FY26, Wipro's IT services revenue declined 1.6

per cent in constant currency to \$10.5 billion, while total bookings rose 14 per cent to \$16.4 billion. Large-deal bookings increased to \$7.8 billion, including four deals with a total contract value of more than \$500 million. The company also expanded its operating margin to 17.2 per cent. Premji said realising business outcomes from AI required more than deploying technology. Enterprises will

need to reimagine processes and workflows, modernise data and enterprise architecture and bring people along during the transformation. He added that this will be a long-term journey requiring new capabilities, operating models and responsible AI governance. He said Wipro continued to invest in AI capabilities, platforms, partnerships and talent through Wipro Intelligence, its unified suite of AI-powered platforms, solutions and offerings. The company is also deploying AI internally, with a significant majority of its workforce having completed advanced AI learning pathways, while building capabilities such as exponential engineers, AI architects, and forward-deployed engineers. CEO and MD Srinu Pallia said AI adoption was accelerating rapidly, and clients were increasingly seeking measurable business out-

comes. “Today, as AI adoption accelerates, we are moving forward with clear intent. AI is reshaping how companies operate, compete and grow. The pace of change is accelerating, and expectations are much higher,” he said. Pallia said Wipro had established an AI Native Business and Platforms Unit to deepen its AI focus as it pivots towards a platform-plus-services model. **WIPRO VENTURES** Wipro has also committed \$500 million to Wipro Ventures to invest in frontier start-ups across AI, data and security, while expanding partnerships with AI labs, start-ups and academic institutions. Over the past year, Wipro launched 10 innovation labs globally and established an applied AI Centre of Excellence for cloud models powered by Anthropic.

ICICI Pru Life Q1 profit up 28% at ₹386 crore

Our Bureau
Kolkata

ICICI Prudential Life Insurance on Wednesday reported around 28 per cent year-on-year growth in standalone net profit at ₹386.18 crore in the first quarter of this fiscal as its net premium income grew over 14 per cent y-o-y. The private life insurance company had registered a net profit of ₹302.08 crore in the first quarter last fiscal. According to a stock exchange filing, the insurer's new premium income witnessed a 14.65 per cent increase to ₹9,749.33 crore in Q1FY27 from ₹8503.19 crore in Q1FY26. The first-year premium increased 18.43 per cent y-o-y at ₹1,711.86 crore,

Scorecard			
	Q1FY27	Q1FY26	Y-o-Y change (%)
Net profit	386.18	302.08	27.84
Net premium income	9749.33	8503.19	14.65

Source: Company (All figures are in ₹ crore, except percentages)

whereas renewal premium rose 8.94 per cent y-o-y to ₹5,383.60 crore for the period under review. Single premium witnessed an increase of 22.9 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,155.17 crore in the first quarter of the current financial year. During the period under review, persistency ratios for 13th month and 61st month grew 200 basis points and 190 basis points y-o-y to 86 per cent and 61.9 per cent, respectively. Annualised premium equivalent grew 14.6 per cent year-on-year from ₹1,864 crore in Q1FY26 to

₹2,136 crore in Q1FY27. Within that, savings APE stood at ₹1,540 crore and overall protection APE stood at ₹596 crore. Value of new business grew 24.9 per cent y-o-y from ₹457 crore in Q1FY26 to ₹571 crore in Q1FY27 with a margin of 26.7 per cent. **FOCUS AREA** “We reported a new business premium growth of 21.3 per cent year-on-year in Q1FY27 on the back of policies growth of 13.2 per cent. Protection continues to be our focus area, and we

registered a strong growth of 60.4 per cent y-o-y in our retail protection business in Q1FY27, driven by GST exemption on protection products and various company-led initiatives. This marks the third consecutive quarter of retail protection growth exceeding 40 per cent following GST reforms,” said ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Anup Bagchi.

NEW NAME “The board of directors recently approved a proposal to rename the company as ICICI Life Insurance Ltd, subject to relevant approvals. The proposed name reflects the strength, trust and legacy associated with the ICICI franchise,” said Bagchi.

ICICI Lombard net falls 46%

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Non-life insurer ICICI Lombard General Insurance on Wednesday reported a 46 per cent year-on-year fall in net profit at ₹403.17 crore for the first quarter this fiscal, impacted by a ₹165 crore increase in claim reserves in its motor third-party portfolio. The insurer's net profit for the first quarter last fiscal stood at ₹747.08 crore. During Q1FY27, its net premium underwritten rose 17.70 per cent year-on-year at ₹6,603.73 crore from ₹5,610.52 crore in Q1FY26, according to the company's stock exchange filing. “Judgment of the Supreme court resulted in an increase in claim reserves of ₹1.65 billion in our motor TP

portfolio. This had an additional impact on our combined ratio of 2.8 per cent,” said the insurer. Excluding the impact, the combined ratio for Q1FY27 stood at 102.3 per cent against 102.2 per cent for Q1FY26. Gross direct premium income of the company was at ₹8,318 crore in Q1FY27 compared to ₹7,735 crore in Q1FY26, a growth of 7.5 per cent year-on-year, against the industry growth of 10.9 per cent. **SC JUDGMENT** Notably, the Supreme Court, in a recent judgment delivered on June 11, recognised the economic value of unpaid domestic work performed by homemakers while determining the compensation under the Motor Vehicles Act.

SEBI tightens conflict safeguards with launch of recusal framework

Reuters

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Wednesday introduced a formal recusal framework requiring its senior officials to step aside from matters where they face personal, professional or financial conflicts.

The framework also allows the public to flag potential conflicts and mandates annual disclosure of recusal data.



able and immovable assets to an internal ethics office, which will also be responsible for handling complaints related to potential conflicts of interest. Disclosure requirements for whole-time members also cover family members, relatives, past professional interests, assets, liabilities and investment holdings.

TENANT NAMES Officials will also have to disclose rental arrangements, including tenant names, whethertenant names are SEBI-regulated entities. SEBI will maintain a digital record of conflicts and disclosures and publish annual recusal data. It will include summaries of recusals by the chair, whole-time members, part-time members and senior officials to appear in the regulator's annual report.

family members, relatives, close friends, associates from the previous three years, professional relationships, or material financial interests. The regulator defined a material financial interest as investmentsof more than 2 million rupees in an entity or holdings representing over 5 per cent of an official's total financial investments. Senior officers, including whole-time members and the Chairperson, will be required to disclose their mov-

HDFC Life Insurance Q1 net rises 11.5%

Our Bureau
Kolkata

HDFC Life Insurance on Wednesday reported 11.46 per cent year-on-year growth in consolidated net profit at ₹611.19 crore for the first quarter of this fiscal, backed by 15 per cent y-o-y growth in net premium income during the period. The private sector life insurer had registered a net profit of ₹548.35 crore in the first quarter last fiscal. Net premium income rose 15.05 per cent y-o-y at ₹16,727.68 crore, compared to ₹14,539.42 crore in the corresponding period last fiscal. **RENEWAL PREMIUM** The first-year premium increased 7.30 per cent y-o-y at ₹2,746.34 crore, whereas renewal premium rose 18.76 per cent y-o-y to ₹9,033.26 crore for the period under review.

Scorecard			
	Q1FY27	Q1FY26	Y-o-Y change (%)
Net Profit	611.19	548.35	11.46
Net Premium Income	16,727.63	14,539.42	15.05

Source: Company (All figures are in ₹ crore, except percentages)

During the first quarter this fiscal, total annualised premium equivalent (APE) grew 9 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,515 crore, whereas value of new business (VNB) also witnessed a 9 per cent y-o-y growth at ₹879 crore. VNB margin for Q1FY27 stood at 25 per cent compared to 25.1 per cent for Q1FY26. The company said excluding the impact of GST, VNB margins stood at 25.6 per cent and VNB grew 11 per cent during the period under review. “New business margins stood at 25 per cent aided by better product profile, which helped absorb scale-related pressure and a GST impact of approximately 60 basis points. Residual GST impact

now stands at 60 basis points, and we remain on track to fully neutralise it over the coming quarter. Going forward, while margins should improve with scale and product mix, as stated at the beginning of this year, we will continue to prioritise growth over margin expansion, and hence we expect new business margins to remain range-bound at current levels,” said Vibha Padalkar, Managing Director and CEO, HDFC Life Insurance. “The 13-month persistency moderated by 200 basis points to 84 per cent, broadly in line with our expectations and driven largely by specific cohorts and softer collections in ULIP products,” said Padalkar.

Deoleo bets big on India, targets ₹500 crore Figaro business by FY27-end

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Spanish olive oil major Deoleo is stepping up investments behind its Figaro brand in India as it works towards building a ₹450-500 crore business by the end of FY27 by expanding distribution, deepening quick-commerce and broadening its portfolio beyond edible oils. The company expects India's ₹880 crore olive oil market to accelerate from annual growth of about 8 per cent over the past three years to 12-15 per cent going forward, expanding to nearly ₹2,000 crore by 2034 and creating one of the strongest long-term growth opportunities in its global portfolio.

“India represents one of the most exciting opportunities within Deoleo's global portfolio. This market is large, diverse and evolving, making it strategically important for the long-term growth of the category. We continue to see significant headroom for expansion,” Tomislav Bucic, Chief North Europe and APAC-MEA Officer, Deoleo, told *businessline*. Industry estimates place Deoleo India's turnover in the ₹400-450 crore range in FY26 after operating in the ₹300-400 crore bracket in FY25. While the company declined to provide revenue guidance, executives said India is expected to grow faster than Deoleo's global business, steadily increasing its



Tomislav Bucic, Chief North Europe and APAC-MEA Officer, Deoleo

contribution to the group's worldwide portfolio.

GROWTH PLAYBOOK The investment push coincides with Figaro's first packaging and positioning overhaul in its 100-year history and its first India campaign, featuring actor Sunil Grover. Alongside the communication refresh, Deoleo is reor-

ganising its portfolio across pure olive oil, extra virgin olive oil and extra light olive oil, introducing new PET packaging and extending the brand into premium baby care through Figaro Baby Massage Oil. At the centre of the relaunch is Figaro's “multi-purpose” proposition, which according to the company, already contributes nearly 48 per cent of Figaro India's business, making it the brand's largest consumption segment. “Multi-purpose consumption has emerged as an important driver of growth for the brand. Through a sharper positioning, refreshed packaging and stronger communication, we are creating a more distinctive identity that reflects how

consumers already engage with Figaro today,” said Vishal Sarin, General Manager, Deoleo India. Extra light olive oil remains the company's volume driver because of its suitability for high-heat Indian cooking, while pure and extra virgin olive oil are positioned for sautéing, salads, drizzling and wellness-focused consumption. Rather than focusing only on market share, Deoleo said its immediate priority is expanding India's olive oil category. “As market leaders, if somebody has to take ownership of growing the category in the country, it has to be us. The category is massively under-penetrated in a country like India,” said Sarin, noting that household penet-

ration remains below one per cent. The company estimates it currently commands more than 40 per cent of India's market and believes rising health awareness, premiumisation and changing food habits will significantly widen the consumer base. Distribution has changed sharply over the past three years. General trade's share of olive oil sales has declined to around 45 per cent from 64 per cent, while modern trade contributes 25 per cent and e-commerce, including quick-commerce, 30 per cent. Together, modern trade and e-commerce now account for 55 per cent of category sales, with tier-2 and tier-3 cities emerging as fastest-growing markets.

Union Bank of India Q1 net up 30% as net interest income rises

Scorecard			
	Q1FY27 (₹ cr)	Q1FY26 (₹ cr)	% Change
Net profit	5,332	4,116	29.54
Net Interest income	10,037	9,113	10.14
Non-interest income	4,603	4,486	2.61
Operating profit	8,003	6,909	15.83
Provisions	2,670	2,793	-4.40
Global deposits	12,83,366	12,39,933	3.50
Global advances	10,96,331	9,74,489	12.50
GNPA %	2.65	3.52	
NNPA %	0.47	0.62	

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Union Bank of India's first quarter (Q1FY27) net profit rose by a healthy 29.54 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) at ₹5,332 crore on the back of a decent increase in net interest income, decline in provisions and tight leash on operating expenses. India's fifth-largest public sector bank had reported a net profit of ₹4,116 crore in the year-ago quarter. MD & CEO Asheesh Pandey said the bank's operating profit (at ₹8,003 crore) crossed the ₹8,000 crore mark for the first time. Further, the bank will defend the net interest margin (which improved a shade to 2.80 per cent from 2.76 per cent in Q1FY26) and make it better.

FCNR (B) DEPOSITS He noted that the bank will mobilise about \$1.5-2.0 billion via fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank)/FCNR (B) deposits under (at the RBI's concessional swap window, which is available till September-end 2026. Since early June 2026, when the RBI announced measures to attract foreign capital, the bank has so far raised \$105 million from NRIs via FCNR (B) deposits without providing any leverage. Pandey said there are plans afoot to mop up around \$200 million to \$300 million via overseas foreign currency borrowing (OFCB). Going forward, the bank may mobilise funds via Em-

ployee Stock Purchase Scheme (ESPS) at an appropriate time. In the reporting quarter, UBI's net interest income (difference between interest earned and interest expended) was up 10 per cent y-o-y at ₹10,037 crore (₹9,113 crore in the year-ago period). Non-interest income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, edged up about 3 per cent y-o-y to ₹4,603 crore (₹4,486 crore). Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPAs) position improved to 2.65 per cent of gross advances as of June-end 2026 against 3.52 per cent as of June-end 2025. Net NPAs position, too, improved to 0.47 per cent of net advances against 0.62 per cent.

Global advances increased 12.50 per cent y-o-y to ₹10,96,331 crore as of June-end 2026 on the back of 13.11 per cent y-o-y increase in domestic advances (at ₹10,61,128 crore) even as overseas advances declined 3.26 per cent y-o-y (at ₹35,203 crore). The growth in domestic advances was powered by 16.49 per cent increase in MSME advances, followed by large corporate (15.32 per cent), retail (12.06 per cent) and agriculture (6.75 per cent). Global deposits rose 3.50 per cent y-o-y at ₹12,83,366 crore as of June-end 2026. Within this, domestic deposits nudged up 3.49 per cent y-o-y to 12,82,770.

NOTICE

NOTICE OF THE 30TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, E-VOTING INFORMATION AND BOOK CLOSURE

Notice is hereby given that the 30th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the members of V-Guard Industries Ltd. ("the Company") will be held on Tuesday, August 11, 2026, at 11.00 A.M., through Video Conferencing (VC)/ Other Audio-Visual Means (OAVM) to transact the Business, as set out in the Notice of AGM in compliance with General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 read with the circulars issued earlier in this regard by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") (collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars") w.r.t. conducting AGM through VC/ OAVM, from time to time, without the physical presence of the Members at a common venue. The Company has sent the Notice for 30th AGM of the Company along with the Annual Report for the F.Y. 2025-26, through electronic mode only, to those members whose e-mail address is registered with the Company / Registrar and Transfer Agent, M/s MUFG Intime India Private Limited ("RTA") and/or Depositories (National Securities Depository Limited ("NSDL") and Central Depository Services (India) Limited ("CDSL")). Further, pursuant to Regulation 36(1)(b) of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015 ("SEBI Listing Regulations"), a letter providing the web-link, including the exact path, where complete details of the Annual Report are available, has been sent to the registered postal address of those members who have not registered their e-mail IDs. The aforesaid communications were duly completed on July 14, 2026.

The Notice of the 30th AGM along with the Annual Report of the Company for the Financial Year 2025-26 is available under the 'Investor Relations' section in the website of the Company at www.vguardindia.com. The Annual Report, can be accessed directly at <https://www.vguardindia.com/investor-relations/AGM-2026>. The aforesaid documents are also available on the website of the Stock Exchanges, BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and in the CDSL's website at www.evotingindia.com.

Remote e-voting and e-voting during the AGM:

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended from time to time and Regulation 44 of SEBI Listing Regulations, members are provided with the facility to cast their votes on all resolutions set forth in the Notice convening the AGM using the remote e-voting (e-voting from a place other than venue of the AGM) before the AGM as well as e-voting during the AGM and for this purpose, the Company has appointed CDSL to facilitate voting through electronic means. Those members or their mandates whose name appear in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by Depositories, as on Tuesday, August 4, 2026 (**cut-off date**) shall be entitled to vote and avail the facility of remote e-voting before the AGM as well as the e-voting during the AGM. The voting rights of the members shall be in proportion to their share of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date. The detailed instructions for e-voting are given in the Notice convening the AGM.

The remote e-voting period commences on Saturday, August 8, 2026 at 9.00 A.M. and ends on Monday, August 10, 2026 at 5.00 P.M. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL for voting thereafter and it shall not be allowed beyond the aforesaid end date and time. Members who have not cast their votes through remote e-voting can attend and participate in the AGM through VC/ OAVM and cast their vote through their vote during the AGM. Members who have cast their vote on resolutions by remote e-voting prior to the AGM shall also be eligible to participate at the AGM through VC/ OAVM but shall not be entitled to cast their votes again during the AGM.

Any person who acquires shares of the Company and becomes a member of the Company after sending the Notice for 30th AGM electronically, and holds shares as on the cut-off date, i.e., Tuesday, August 4, 2026, may obtain the User ID and Password by writing e-mail to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com. The detailed procedure for obtaining User ID and password is provided in the Notice of the AGM. However, if such a member is already registered with CDSL for remote e-voting, then the member can use his/her existing User ID and password for casting the vote.

Members who need assistance before or during the AGM regarding e-voting facility and/ or VC/ OAVM facility or in case of any grievances related to e-voting, can contact Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, A/P, Central Depository Services (India) Limited, A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mill Compound, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or call the toll free no. 1800 21 09911.

Helpdesk for Individual Shareholders holding securities in demat mode for any technical issues related to login through Depository i.e., CDSL and NSDL:

Login type	Helpdesk details
Individual Shareholders holding securities in Demat mode with CDSL	Members facing any technical issue in login can contact NSDL helpdesk by sending a request at helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at toll free no. 1800 21 09911
Individual Shareholders holding securities in Demat mode with NSDL	Members facing any technical issue in login can contact NSDL helpdesk by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or call at toll free no. 022 - 4866 7000 and 022 - 2499 7000

The Members are requested to carefully read all the notes set out in the Notice of the AGM and in particular, instructions for joining the AGM through VC/ OAVM, manner of casting vote through Remote e-voting and e-voting during the AGM.

By the Order of the Board
For V-GUARD INDUSTRIES LIMITED

Kochi
14.07.2026

Vikas Kumar Tak
Company Secretary

V-GUARD INDUSTRIES LIMITED, Regd. Office: 42/962, Vennala High School Road, Vennala P.O, Ennakulam - 682 028, Kerala, India. IPh: 0464-4335000. E-mail: investors@vguard.in Website: www.vguard.in ICRN: 131200KL1996PLC010010

CM YK 100% CH-CH

Smoke and noise

Ethanol push has left consumers confused

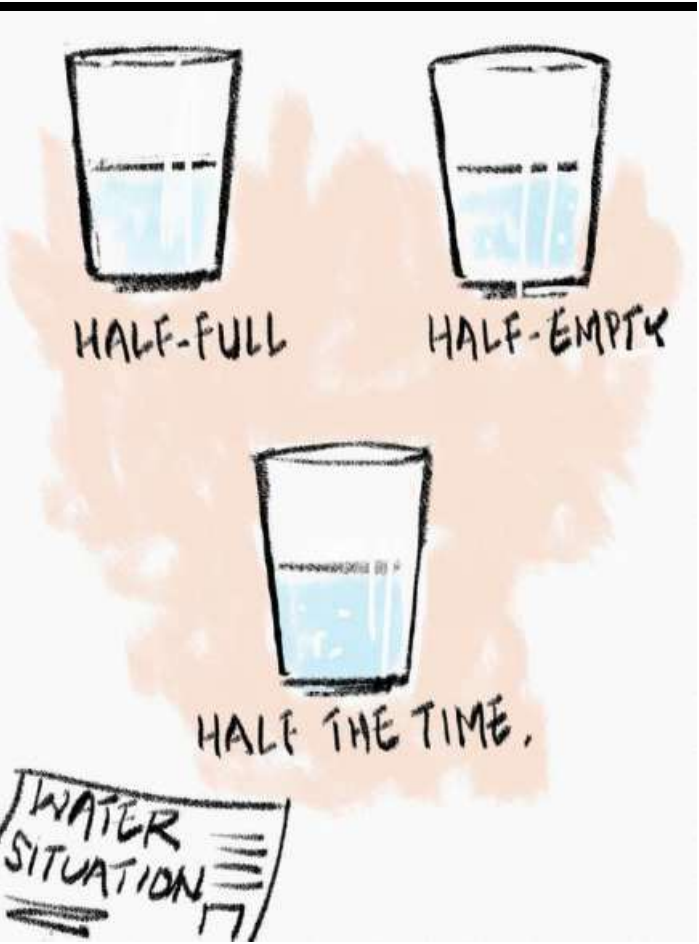
Auto vehicle users have raised an outcry over the impact of the ‘E-20 mandate’. The consumer debate centres around two aspects: the impact of a 20 per cent ethanol blend on fuel efficiency, and on the wear and tear of the vehicle engines. Consumers claim that the impact on both counts is negative, whereas the Centre has said, through a recently issued FAQ on ethanol blending, that fuel efficiency does indeed fall but there is no evidence of vehicular damage. The second assertion is rather confusing.

To put this debate in context, the Centre has mandated that all BS VI vehicles are required to “fully meet” E20 emission standards” from April 2026. Meanwhile, the availability of E-20 petrol is already in place. Thanks to 1,100-1,200 crore litres of ethanol being produced annually now, the 20 per cent blending target was achieved last July — five years before target. With this rapid transition, consumers have been caught off-guard. They want clarity on whether their vehicles are fit for E-20 fuel. Many would perhaps be willing to pay for ethanol-free petrol, but that has virtually vanished from the market. The FAQ says supplying unblended petrol in small quantities is not feasible when the distribution has moved to ethanol. Yet, it is vague on whether the existing vehicles should be modified or replaced. It says that Maruti Suzuki serviced 1.5 crore older vehicles ‘that were never originally certified as E-20 compatible’ without any damage to rubber components, fuel lines and engines, as claimed by consumers. If this is so, the need for ‘E-20 compatibility’ seems unclear. Consumers need clarity on their options. With E-20 becoming mandatory, they have been forced to accept a fuel efficiency reduction of 3.5 per cent with respect to the E-10 base, and nearly double that from petrol as base. Auto firms must be open on their plans, so that consumers can exercise an informed choice, which includes moving to EVs or CNG.

The energy shock has infused a sense of urgency into the ethanol push. Assuming a ball park figure of ₹2 lakh crore in petroleum imports, a 20 per cent reduction in quantity of crude imports is expected to save ₹30,000-40,000 crore — without taking into account losses in fuel efficiency. This is a huge benefit, and to push this cause the government purchases ethanol at attractive prices. The consumer pays more as a result of this incentive to grain and sugarcane farmers. The issue of grain diversion, which accounts for two-thirds of ethanol supplies, is not addressed here, nor is the problem of water use. Of course, politically speaking, the ethanol focus can help in the elections next year in Uttar Pradesh and other States where sugarcane, paddy and maize farmer lobbies are strong.

The Centre must take a long-term view on fuel choices, which reconciles multiple objectives — curbing imports, securing lifecycle environmental benefits, and keeping consumer costs down. A combination of EV batteries, ethanol, CNG and petrol needs to be visualised.

POCKET



Perils of unchecked cybercrime

LETHAL THREAT. India must pursue bilateral, multilateral engagement to dismantle scam networks, as in South East Asia



AMITABH RANJAN

In 2025, India lost a whopping ₹22,495 crore to cybercrimes, saw 28.15 lakh reported cases, a 24 per cent surge in complaints over 2024, a year which witnessed an over 200 per cent year-on-year to ₹22,845 crore. Can a nation haemorrhage over ₹22,000 crore a year from its digital economy and still credibly aspire to be Viksit Bharat by 2047? India’s digital transformation is a genuine achievement. UPI processes billions of transactions monthly. Aadhaar has redefined identity at scale. But every revolution has a side-effect; for Digital India, it is the sprawling criminal ecosystem, now ranked among the most consequential threats to the country’s development ambitions.

THE SCAM FACTORIES

The most chilling dimension of this crisis is transnational. Across the Golden Triangle, the tri-junction of Myanmar, Laos and Thailand, and in compounds along the Cambodia-Thailand border, organised syndicates, many with Chinese backing, run industrial-scale scam operations. Young Indians, lured by fraudulent job offers, have been trafficked into these compounds, then scripted and deployed as callers running investment scams and Digital Arrest frauds targeting people globally. The digital arrest scam is amongst the most psychologically brutal financial crimes. A caller posing as a customs or narcotics officer tells the victim about his/her Aadhaar being linked to trafficking or money laundering, then placing the victim under a fake ‘video surveillance arrest’, and systematically drained of the hard-earned savings. Reported cases climbed from roughly

40,000 in 2022 to 60,000 in 2023 to nearly 1.24 lakh in 2024, with cumulative losses crossing ₹2,600 crore by early 2025, according to Ministry of Home Affairs data. In January 2026, Delhi Police’s Special Cell dismantled a Taiwan-linked syndicate, handled from Pakistan that defrauded citizens of nearly ₹100 crore by posing as Anti-Terrorist Squad officers. Another incident just recently highlighted the scale, in form of some Chinese battery management apps shooting down the e-Rickshaw operations in Delhi creating havoc with traffic and threatening people’s lives. The government promptly ordered the removal of these apps from app-stores. These are not disorganised, opportunistic crimes; it is a cross-border enterprise with outstanding supply chains and geopolitical enablers. India’s critical infrastructure has repeatedly proven to be vulnerable. In November 2022, a ransomware attack on AIIMS Delhi crippled outpatient, inpatient, laboratory and billing services for nearly two weeks, corrupting files on five servers and encrypting roughly 1.3 terabytes of data. The breach was feared to have compromised records of 3-4 crore patients. The government later confirmed the attack to Parliament. CERT-In, Delhi Police, MHA and NIA were mobilised and investigators traced digital trails to Hong Kong and China. Separately, questions have been raised about the integrity of the CoWIN platform after

Financial losses from cybercrime grew roughly 41-fold in four years, from ₹551 crore in 2021 to over ₹22,800 crore in 2024, with investment-related scams alone now accounting for over three-quarters of the money lost



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

allegations of a 2023 data exposure. India has repeatedly featured among the world’s most-targeted nations in industry cyber-threat assessments. Financial losses grew roughly 41-fold in four years, from ₹551 crore in 2021 to over ₹22,800 crore in 2024, with investment-related scams alone now accounting for over three-quarters of the money lost. Every fraudulent transaction erodes household savings that would otherwise fuel consumption; every ransomware attack disrupts productivity; every major breach raises the cost of capital for firms courting foreign investment. Cybercrime is not merely a law-enforcement problem that occasionally hurts the economy, it is a structural drag on growth. Singapore has built cyber-resilience into its economic brand; Israel has turned it into a strategic industry. India, aspiring to be the preferred partner for next-generation digital supply chains, cannot afford to be cyber-vulnerable. The scale of the problem has become a “cyberdemic”. A retired civil servant loses a lifetime’s savings to a fake stock advisory on WhatsApp; a young graduate is trafficked into a scam compound; a senior citizen is held in psychological captivity for days by a voice claiming to be from the CBI. NITI Aayog has also acknowledged that the emotional toll of such crimes frequently exceeds the financial one. Generative AI is accelerating the threat. Deepfake audio and video are increasingly used to impersonate family members, executives and officials in real time and digital literacy without accompanying cyber literacy is dangerously incomplete, particularly among India’s newest internet users in Tier-2 and Tier-3 towns.

FIVE-POINT PLAN India’s institutional response has begun. I4C has helped freeze over ₹8,031 crore in fraudulent transactions, and the Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting System has saved over ₹7,130

The case for hydrogen trains must be studied

India’s first hydrogen train could generate practical knowledge in fuel-cell operation, storage, safety and long-term reliability

Sudhanshu Mani

After more than three years of ambitious announcements, social media teasers and repeated postponements, Indian Railways’ (IR’s) first hydrogen-powered train is finally ready. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is expected to flag it off later this week. The train will operate between Jind and Sonipat and consists of two hydrogen-powered driving power cars, each producing 1,200 kW of traction power, and eight passenger coaches. The launch deserves recognition. Hydrogen fuel cells generate electricity while emitting only water vapour, and the train represents a significant engineering achievement. Although the fuel-cell stack itself is imported, an Indian company has successfully developed the propulsion, control systems and overall integration. India thus becomes only the third country, after Germany and China, to introduce hydrogen trains in commercial passenger service. Yet technological milestones should encourage informed debate rather than unquestioned celebration. Germany, which pioneered hydrogen rail technology with the Alstom Coradia iLint in 2022, has already scaled back many of its operations, with several routes shifting towards battery-powered

trains after encountering issues such as fuel-cell degradation, supply chain challenges and operational reliability. Japan, Sweden, South Korea, Switzerland and the US have confined themselves largely to demonstration projects while continuing to evaluate the technology. India is perhaps the only country to run a hydrogen-powered passenger train on a fully electrified route under the wire; hydrogen trains are designed as an alternative to polluting diesel trains on non-electrified regional lines. HERITAGE ROUTES As an afterthought, therefore, it changed the discourse to ‘Hydrogen for Heritage’, declaring that 35 such trains shall be developed for eight scenic, ecologically sensitive narrow-gauge and metre-gauge heritage routes. The concept has merit. Heritage railways traverse environmentally sensitive regions where conventional electrification may be undesirable, and hydrogen could potentially offer a cleaner alternative. However, these routes are small, geographically dispersed and located in remote areas. Establishing hydrogen production, storage and refuelling infrastructure at each location would be expensive and operationally demanding. Moreover, despite a budgetary allocation of about ₹2,800 crore three years ago, little



HYDROGEN TRAIN. A vital case study ANI

visible progress has been made towards developing these heritage train prototypes. The broader question concerns hydrogen itself. Hydrogen is often described as the fuel of the future, but it is more accurately an energy carrier than a primary fuel. Unlike coal, petroleum or uranium, hydrogen must first be manufactured using energy before it can be used. It is then compressed or liquefied, transported, stored and finally converted back into electricity inside a fuel cell. Every stage consumes energy, leaving hydrogen with significantly lower overall efficiency than battery-electric systems. However, inexplicably, IR has not yet pursued battery-powered trains in any significant way. Hydrogen’s environmental

credentials also depend on how it is produced. More than 95 per cent of global hydrogen is currently derived from natural gas, a process that emits carbon dioxide. Truly green hydrogen, produced by splitting water using renewable electricity, remains considerably more expensive. Unless the electricity used for electrolysis itself comes from renewable sources, hydrogen cannot be described as a completely green fuel. Despite these challenges hydrogen offers considerable promise in sectors where batteries face fundamental limitations, such as green steel production, fertilizer manufacture, long-distance shipping and perhaps aviation. Railways, however, present a far more nuanced case. The Jind-Sonipat prototype will nevertheless provide invaluable operational experience. Indian engineers will acquire practical knowledge in fuel-cell operation, hydrogen storage, maintenance, safety and long-term reliability. That experience makes the project worthwhile, provided future decisions are guided by evidence and close study of international experience rather than by technological enthusiasm.

The writer is Retd. General Manager/Indian Railways, Leader of Vande Bharat project & Independent Rail Consultant

● LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Inflation concerns

The recent rise in retail inflation is a worrying development that deserves urgent policy attention. Although CPI inflation at 3.9 per cent remains slightly below the RBI’s projection, persistent increases in food, transport and restaurant prices continue to erode household purchasing power. Below-normal monsoon rainfall has heightened concerns over agricultural output, raising the risk of further food inflation. At the same time, higher petrol and diesel prices are increasing transportation costs

and are likely to trigger a broader pass-through effect, pushing up the prices of essential goods and services. In this challenging environment, the Monetary Policy Committee must strike a careful balance between containing inflation and sustaining economic growth. M Jeyaram Sholavandan (TN) Positive development This refers to the article ‘Not a taxing matter’ (July 15). The growing shift in behaviour among Indian taxpayers

from ‘tax adventurers’ to ‘tax compliant’ is a positive trend that supports the country’s long-term financial health. Entities are increasingly realising the futility of loophole-hunting in tax legislation, which typically results in lengthy and costly legal battles. Simplifying and rationalising complex, cumbersome laws, implementing them transparently through a high level of digitisation, enabling real-time data tracking by multiple agencies, and setting fair, reasonable tax rates have made tax compliance the least risky option,

one with the highest long-term value for most entities. Kamal Laddha Bengaluru Realigning education This refers to the article ‘Industry-academia alignment must for growth’ (July 15). The article highlights critical challenges in making India’s academia more impactful from a global perspective. The article succinctly highlights the importance of new age technology to be embedded in our curriculum. At the same time the need for closer

collaboration between industry and academia has been highlighted. In this context, it is important to highlight that the education courses which are valued and sought after by the economy already have an embedded program of building hands-on experience as part of the learning curriculum. All professional bodies and the industry must come together to find similar solutions so the future talent pool of India remains relevant and supports our economic growth. Pradip Menon Kochi

Sanctions, tariffs are back

Using these unlikely to help end Ukraine, Iran wars

Sridhar Krishnaswami

At a time when the Trump administration is getting fully involved in Phase Two of the Iran war through renewed hostilities in an around the Strait of Hormuz and retaliatory strikes across the Gulf nations, it has opened the prospect of another front by way of punitive measures against a small clutch of countries.

The US Senate — with the full blessings of the White House — seems to be working overtime to give finishing touches to the bipartisan Graham-Blumenthal Bill as a way of paying high tributes to Senator Lindsey Graham who suddenly passed away. Senator Richard Blumenthal is a Democrat from Connecticut.

The senior Republican from South Carolina intended to punish countries like China and India who in his view were bankrolling President Vladimir Putin's war against Ukraine.

BIPARTISAN INITIATIVE
The bipartisan initiative that has been doing the rounds since April 2025 originally intended to slap 500 per cent tariffs on top buyers of Russian oil and gas, but the revised bill places the cap at 100 per cent.

Those lawmakers eager to push the bill across the Senate floor are worried that President Trump's attempts to add Iran and Hezbollah provisions could derail the process. There are at least 26 co-sponsors of the current bill.

From a sweeping 500 per cent to 100 per cent is not the only change. Apparently there is an exemption for countries that import less than 15 per cent of Russia's natural gas exports, but punitive measures are planned for Russia's shadow fleet — on that country's central bank and on state owned energy projects.

It remains to be seen what exactly the White House wants of Iran and Hezbollah. Some reports suggest that the intention is to target Russian defence industries that may be working with Tehran. "With all due respect to the President, he has approved this bill, and we should move forward with this bill rather than opening it... to other potential targets," Senator Blumenthal has said.

India has long been on the radar of Senator Graham for being one of the largest buyers of discounted Russian crude knowing full well the implications of slapping additional tariffs and restrictions on Indian exports,



PUNITIVE STEP. US Senate finalising Graham-Blumenthal Bill

especially at a time when New Delhi and Washington are giving finishing touches to a trade deal. It is a known fact that while India's import of Russian gas is negligible, it is one of the top importers of Russian crude, accounting for around 35 per cent of its total crude imports.

On top of this, India is said to be one of the top refiners of Russian crude for jet fuel and diesel.

In the rush to give finishing touches to the legacy of Senator Graham, one wonders whether the implications of the punitive measures are being thought out carefully. To believe that Beijing will be a passive spectator to sweeping 100 per cent tariffs and sanctions is naïve.

A strong economy like China has shown the Trump administration that it is no pushover when it comes to retaliation — the tariff wars since February 2025 are a testimony to that.

Further, it showed Washington that it could use its muscle in critical minerals to impact American defence and hi-tech industries, not to speak of its own export controls. Tariffs and sanctions could bite China's economy, but not for long.

WON'T MAKE A DIFFERENCE
But the big question that lawmakers would have to ask is whether further sanctions on Russia is going to make any difference to the Ukraine war which is already in its fifth year. Time and again Moscow seems to have re-worked its strategies on the battlefield, but hardly on its objectives.
Tightening sanctions on Russia or widening the scope of the Graham-Blumenthal Bill to include Iran would do little to end two conflicts in different theatres.

The writer is a senior journalist who has reported from Washington DC on North America and United Nations



MRIDUL SAGGAR

Business as usual by international organisations in the hope of not upsetting the apple cart defined by the power structures may invite redundancy. They need to quickly revamp themselves by actions but restrict themselves to their core-competencies.

The July 2026 IMF World Economic Outlook (WEO) update made only minor adjustments to global growth but included a surprisingly large upward revisions to inflation forecasts (0.3 percentage point (ppt) for 2026, 0.2 ppt for 2027). These were driven by expected higher energy and food prices. But the IMF's optimism that this won't spill over into core inflation contradicts its own growth projections, which lack the demand destruction needed to keep core inflation steady.

The sharp revision in inflation forecasts came from a 8.6 per cent jump in its oil price forecast after it took into account the oil future curve of June 10 in place of March 10. However, the forecasts are distorted by giving equal weight to WTI, Brent and Dubai Fateh even though Brent sets the price for roughly two-thirds of globally traded physical crudes.

This past week, oil futures for some tenors surged by about 15 per cent, making the IMF's macroeconomic forecasts questionable. Whenever there are spikes in energy prices, the IMF's macroeconomic forecasts have a structural disconnect with macroeconomic realities. The cascading impacts do not sufficiently get captured in their models. Crude oil futures are not an optimal predictor of their future spot prices. Given high volatilities, why does the IMF rely on a single day's futures curve for energy prices, rather than modelling country-level energy supply and demand dynamics?

The IMF devotes disproportionately large resources to climate issues in relation to energy issues. It is trying to fix the big gaps in the International Financial Architecture (IFA) with several global common (supranational) issues coming to fore. Climate change, pandemics, cyber risks, maritime blockages and seabed resource exploitations, all carry large negative externalities.

They need to be dealt with. But the IMF was conceived for none of these when the Harry Dexter White's Commission laid its blueprint.

Yet, the IMF has happily extended its mandate to cover the IFA gaps as there had been no traction in the G20 for alternative structures. Even the Eminent Persons Group chaired by



REUTERS

IMF must stick to its core competencies

OFF COURSE. The IMF must pull back from areas like climate finance where it lacks expertise, and focus on resolving the ever-growing debt bubble

Tharman Shanmugaratnam under the German Presidency focussed only on fine-tuning and fell well short of recommending an alternative architecture. The G20 Expert Group, Co-Chaired by Larry Summers and NK Singh under the Indian Presidency, had a much narrower mandate confined to Multilateral Development Banks (MDBs).

Though tasked to deal with trans-boundary challenges such as climate change and health, it got bogged down by seeking consensus on resource augmentations for the existing MDBs than conceiving a blueprint for a structural change of the IFA.

As gaps persisted, the IMF, which neither had expertise in climate, nor in energy, integrated climate finance in its Article IV consultations on the grounds of macro-criticality.

But mitigation, adaptation and green transition are big issues that can best be addressed by creating a separate multilateral institution. The IMF's Resilience and Sustainability Facility is grossly insufficient to meet the climate

Whenever there are spikes in energy prices, the IMF's macroeconomic forecasts have a structural disconnect with macroeconomic realities

finance goals. Instead, it diverts scarce IMF resources from providing global financial safety net.

There is some justification behind the US Treasury Secretary, Scott Bessent's criticism of the "mission creep" that has knocked the IMF and World Bank off course from their mandate. It is a different matter that the US Administration's commitment to multilateralism is itself questionable and is the cause of these intuitions going downhill.

IMMEDIATE ACTION AGENDA
While the geopolitical conflicts have accentuated, the fiscal and monetary space looks enervated. The IMF must reconsider its ability to handle financial crashes. It must get into action to increase its core crisis-handling firepower and re-look how it uses it. Three immediate actions that the IMF need to take are:

The 16th General Review of Quotas (GRQ) along with the NAB (New Arrangements to Borrow) rollback approved by the Board of Governors in 2023 is as good as dead. Despite four extensions, the US, with its 16.5 per cent vote share, will block it from getting requisite consent from 85 per cent vote share. So, the IMF must move to raise supplementary resources from NAB and BBA (Bilateral Borrowing Agreements) and get them weight in the quota formula in the 17th GRQ.

The IMF taking leadership to

resolve the ever-growing debt bubble with global public debt to GDP ratio expected to touch 100 per cent by 2029. The Brady Plan launched in 1989 in similar circumstances had chinks of moral hazard. So, the new plan should focus on mitigating various risks attached to emerging market economies' bond issuances.

The IMF's 2026 Comprehensive Surveillance Review need to pull back from further mission creep and completely abstain from looking at poly-crisis interlinking crises on which the IMF does not have expertise — environment, social unrests, cyber-risks, pandemic, gender, etc.

Instead, it should develop more even-handedness in its policies that has taken a dent with exceptional financing. It hasn't even explained why the FSAP (Financial Sector Assessment Programme) of the most systemically important jurisdiction — the US — has still not been completed or released? Also, why have there been repeated failures of its borrowing programmes, evident in Pakistan borrowing 24 times and Argentina 23 times.

It is time that the IMF comes transparent on its constraints, as sitting out till 2029 will not solve anything, especially if another global financial crisis strikes earlier.

The writer is Professor at IIM Kozhikode. He was formerly RBI ED and had represented India at G20 IFA Working Group. Views are personal

thehindubusinessline. TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

July 16, 2006

NPCIL gets going on additional nuclear capacity

State-owned Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd (NPCIL), the nodal agency for harnessing nuclear power in the country, is working on setting up additional nuclear generation capacity of between 6,000 and 10,000 MWe (mega watts electrical) on the four new sites sanctioned by the Government.

Deviations in VAT rate contained to 3%

The VAT Panel has said the deviations in rates among the implementing States have been contained to a mere 3 per cent of the total universe of 703 items under the new tax system. "The deviations in VAT rates are within 20 items in contrast to the 703 items under the VAT system," Dr Asim Dasgupta, Chairman of the Empowered Committee of State Finance Ministers on VAT, said.

Road operations turn profitable for Government

Instead of paying up (subsidy) to get highways constructed, the Government can expect making substantial money for some stretches. An increasing section of the private sector has started perceiving road operations as profitable venture and is ready to shell out money (called negative grant) to the National Highways Authority of India for building and managing roads.

Boeing unveils new 737 line to boost output

Siddharth Philip

Boeing Co. formally opened its fourth 737 Max assembly line near Seattle on Friday, as the US planemaker looks to cash in on its growing backlog, though output from the factory will initially be at a low rate.

The line inside Boeing's Everett site, where it mainly produces its wide-body models such as the 777, 767 and upcoming 777X, will initially employ about 1,000 workers, Jennifer Boland-Masterson said, a senior director at the company, said during a media tour.

Boeing will adopt a low build rate to iron out any kinks and ensure operations run smoothly, Boland-Masterson said. She declined to specify how quickly the line will scale but said Boeing will add more workers as production increases.

The new assembly line is a key component of Boeing's attempt to ramp up output of its workhorse 737

Max family after the Federal Aviation Administration capped production at 38 planes a month in 2024 following a near-catastrophic accident that led to a wholesale switch of senior leadership.

In May, Chief Executive Officer Kelly Ortberg said the planemaker had been authorised to increase output to 47 planes a month.

RAISING OUTPUT

Boeing eventually aims to raise 737 monthly output to 63, key to paying pay down debt, improving its finances and challenging Airbus SE's dominance in the money-spinning single-aisle aircraft segment.

Boeing's tour showcased an array of tooling and work stations as well as machines hauling a sheathed fuselage that will be assembled on the new production line. Boeing builds 737 Max fuselages at its site in Wichita, Kansas, and transports them by rail to Seattle.

It came days before airlines and parts



BOEING. Looking to clear production backlog with fourth assembly line REUTERS

suppliers from around the world converge outside of London for the Farnborough airshow, with Boeing and Airbus jockeying to unveil blockbuster plane orders.

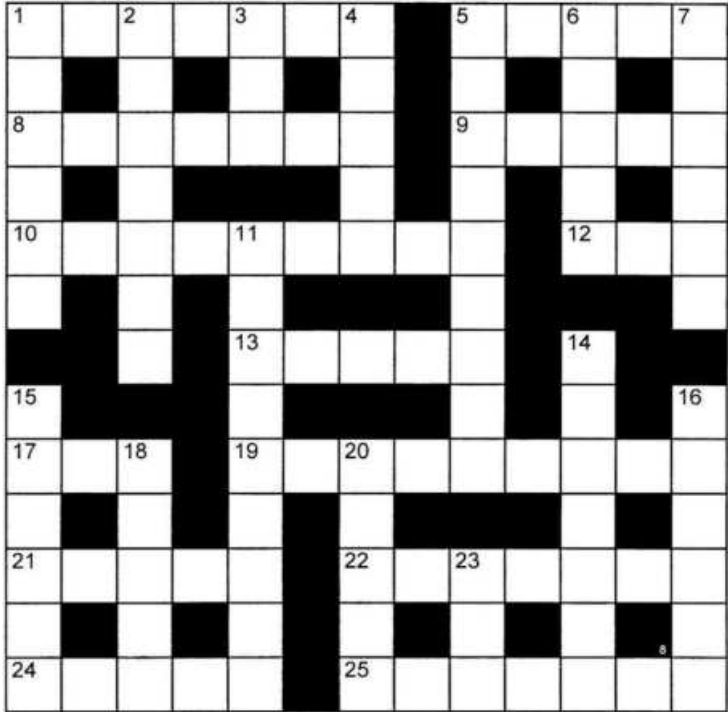
The world's largest planemakers face hurdles to their growth plans, including conquering parts and labour shortages lingering from the coronavirus

pandemic. Airbus has struggled with supply chain constraints while it works to ramp up output of its rival A321neo model and has had to repeatedly push back its target of achieving a production rate of 75 planes a month. This week, workers in Spain kicked off a labour strike in a protest over work conditions over the past years.

The area for the new 737 North line was previously used to assemble the 787 Dreamliner before production of that model was consolidated in North Charleston, South Carolina. Given the space was previously used to build bigger aircraft, Boeing is using the extra floor area to adapt to changing cabin trends.

As airlines add more lie-flat seats to narrow-body aircraft to target premium fliers, the new line has additional stations that give workers time to install complicated interiors without disrupting the rest of the line, Boland-Masterson said. BLOOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2694



EASY

ACROSS

- Hold in regard (7)
- Young horses, junior players (5)
- Citizens of Troy (7)
- Unclothed (5)
- Entangle, involve (9)
- Be visually aware (3)
- Lets fall (5)
- Mat (3)
- Cheered (9)
- To faint (5)
- Unhappy, unlucky (7)
- Division of act (5)
- Add sugar (7)

DOWN

- Sell to the consumer (6)
- Ceased (7)
- An age, particular period (3)
- Opera by Puccini (5)
- Admitted (9)
- Is fond of (5)
- Edged along sideways (6)
- Poverty, need of subsistence (9)
- Quietly happy (7)
- Appointments to meet (6)
- Better than even betting price (4,2)
- Feel one's way blindly (5)
- Plant-louse (5)
- Dish with pastry crust (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Proper feeling in this regard (7)
- Young animals that were meant to be shot (5)
- They worked hard at an opera by Berlioz (7)
- Dane was upset about king who had nothing on (5)
- Limit pace so that it could involve others (9)
- Understand it to be the domain of a bishop (3)
- Ceases to take liquid medicament (5)
- Half of a game for fifteen gets trodden underfoot (3)
- Made happy to have land edged in such a way (9)
- So now is put out by a fainting fit (5)
- Unlucky chap loses his head, getting a smaller amount (7)
- Bit of a fuss made where crime is committed (5)
- In the teens, we turn and sugar the pill (7)

DOWN

- How to sell a litre of it (6)
- Having shortened the vibrating length, didn't go on (7)
- A time that occurs in a December afternoon (3)
- An opera by Puccini for turncoats (5)
- It is admitted one feeds NCOs like this (9)
- Is partial to silk that is woven round end of tie (5)
- Was fawningly moving crabwise (6)
- Might need icing if showing need of subsistence (9)
- Is quite happy with what's inside it (7)
- Attempt to take nothing from sots at such meetings (6)
- A better than even chance that dons do wrong (4,2)
- First get on the line and blindly feel one's way (5)
- Garden pest that could destroy a ship (5)
- Something crusty to be as sweet as (3)

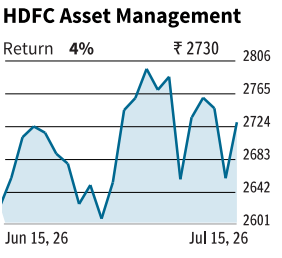
SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2693

ACROSS 1. Thumb 4. Unkempt 8. Nadir 9. Hen-coop 10. Use 11. Unreeling 12. Tusk 13. Dada 18. Intrinsic 20. Ugh 21. Termite 22. Franc 23. Resists 24. Spell

DOWN 1. Tongue-twister 2. Undress 3. Barium 4. Ushers 5. Kennel 6. Maori 7. Topographical 14. Adulate 15. Visits 16. Osiers 17. Scoffs 19. Terms

QUICKLY.

HDFC Mutual Q1 net up 12% at ₹837 crore



Mumbai: HDFC Asset Management Company has reported that its net profit in the June quarter was up 12 per cent at ₹837 crore against ₹748 crore logged in the same period last year, on the back of steady inflows and a rise in assets under management. Revenue increased 14 per cent to ₹1,100 crore (₹968 crore). The quarterly average AUM of the fund house was up 13 per cent at ₹9.35 lakh crore (₹8.29 lakh crore), while the market share was down marginally to 11.2 per cent (11.5 per cent). Excluding the ETF, the total quarterly average AUM was up 10 per cent at ₹8.92 lakh crore (₹8.08 lakh crore). **OUR BUREAU**

Angel One's profit doubles on higher trading

Angel One posted a doubling of quarterly profit on Wednesday, supported by stronger client participation and higher trading volumes. Consolidated profit rose to ₹231 crore in the April-to-June quarter from ₹114 crore a year earlier. Profit rose for the second quarter in a row, after four straight quarters of falls following regulatory changes introduced by the market regulator in late 2024. Angel One, which rolled out its AI-driven assistant in April, said that these tools are improving customer on boarding, support and internal productivity, with its conversational assistant getting over 1.1 million user clicks. Total revenue rose 25.35 per cent to ₹1,430 crore. **REUTERS**

IFSCA unveils direct listing norms

EASE OF BIZ. Proposed framework will facilitate liquidity and exit opportunities for founders, early-stage investors

Our Bureau Ahmedabad

Companies looking to go public without raising fresh capital could soon have a formal route to list in GIFT City, with the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) proposing a regulatory framework for the direct listing of equity shares and convertible securities without an initial public offering (IPO). In a consultation paper, the regulator has proposed detailed eligibility norms, disclosure requirements and pricing mechanisms for companies seeking to list on recognised stock exchanges in the International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) without undertaking a public offer. The regulator said the proposed framework will facilitate liquidity and exit oppor-

tunities for founders, early-stage investors, private equity and venture capital funds, as well as ESOP holders, while allowing companies to avoid shareholder dilution and the underwriting and issuance costs associated with a traditional IPO. According to IFSCA, the route is intended for companies that have already scaled their businesses with capital from founders or institutional investors and do not require fresh fundraising but still want the benefits of being publicly listed. "Companies that seek listing without undertaking a public offer may do so to enhance transparency, corporate governance standards and financial disclosures, meet regulatory, contractual or business requirements that necessitate listing on a recognised stock exchange, avoid dilution of existing shareholders where no addi-



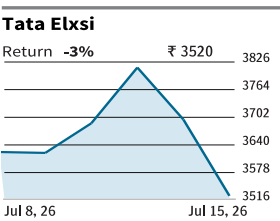
WHO CAN LIST? Companies would be eligible for direct listing if they have operating revenue of at least \$20 million in the latest financial year and pre-tax profit of \$1 million **BLOOMBERG**

tional capital is required, and reduce the overall time required for listing compared with a normal IPO," sources told the *businessline*. The proposal comes as IFSCA looks to broaden the avenues for equity listings in GIFT City after the jurisdiction's first IPO attempt failed to take off. Earlier this year, XED Executive Development withdrew what was slated to be GIFT City's maiden IPO, citing muted investor participation and operational challenges, including KYC-related issues. **ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA** Under the new IFSCA proposal, companies would be eligible for direct listing if they have operating revenue of at least \$20 million in the latest financial year (or on average over the previous three years), pre-tax profit of at least \$1 million or a post-listing market capitalisation (m-cap) of at least \$50 mil-

Analysts give thumbs down to Tata Elxsi on Q1 numbers

Our Bureau Bengaluru

Tata Elxsi shares fell on Wednesday after brokerages flagged concerns over profitability and cut earnings estimates following the company's June quarter results. The stock settled nearly 5 per cent lower at ₹3,520.40, after hitting a 52-week low of ₹3,469.70 on the NSE. The decline came despite the company reporting higher revenue and profit on a y-o-y basis, as brokerages highlighted a sharp margin contraction and uncertainty in key business segments. The company reported an 18.17 per cent increase in net profit to ₹170.59 crore during the Q1 of FY27, driven by



growth in key verticals and strong deal execution. **STRATEGIC GROWTH** "The performance in the quarter reflects the strength and increasing relevance of our design-led and AI-enabled engineering capabilities in our chosen industries," said Tata Elxsi CEO and MD Manoj Raghavan. JP Morgan retained a 'Neutral' rating on Tata Elxsi with a target price of ₹3,500,

describing the quarter as mixed with a revenue beat but a sharp miss on margins. According to JP Morgan, Tata Elxsi continues to target high single-digit revenue growth in FY27 against its estimate of 6.4 per cent growth, although this depends on a recovery in Healthcare where uncertainty remains. JPM said margins contracted sharply by 330 basis points q-o-q due to large deal transition and ramp-up costs, onsite delivery investments, talent investments, customer-related costs and provisions, and one-time annual costs. Kotak Institutional Equities maintained a 'Sell' rating with a target price of ₹3,000, saying Tata Elxsi reported inline revenues but disappoint-

Cube InvIT's ₹5,000-crore IPO to open on July 22 at ₹151-152 price band

Anupama Ghosh Mumbai

Cube Highways Trust on Wednesday fixed a price band of ₹151-152 per unit for its proposed ₹5,000-crore initial public offering (IPO), with the issue scheduled to open for subscription on July 22 and close on July 24. The offer comprises an offer for sale by existing unit holders as the privately listed infrastructure investment trust (InvIT) transitions to a publicly listed InvIT. The trust has already secured commitments worth ₹1,250 crore from five strategic investors ahead of the issue. The strategic investors are



Vinay C Sekar, CEO of Investment Manager, Cube Highways Trust

Prazim Trading and Investment Company Pvt Ltd, HDFC Life Insurance, HDFC Pension Fund Management, Axis Max Life Insurance and WhiteOak Capital REIT & InvIT Alternatives Fund I. The issue will be managed by Kotak Mahindra Capital Company, HDFC Bank, HSBC Securities and Capital

Markets (India) and JM Financial. Vinay C Sekar, Chief Executive Officer of the Investment Manager of Cube Highways Trust, said the decision to publicly list the InvIT was driven by growing domestic investor interest in infrastructure investment trusts. "Infrastructure assets are typically less correlated to equities... investments in InvITs can behave differently from equities and therefore offer genuine diversification in growth portfolios." The trust currently owns 27 highway assets, comprising 18 toll-based and nine annuity-based projects across 12 States and one Union Territory.

Kusumgar jumps 44% on Day 1

Our Bureau Bengaluru

Kusumgar shares made a strong debut on the stock exchanges and extended gains on Wednesday after the engineered fabric manufacturer's initial public offering attracted robust investor demand across categories. On the BSE, the stock debuted at ₹574, a premium of 36.99 per cent over the issue price of ₹419 per share. On the NSE, the stock listed at ₹569, up 35.79 per cent from the offer price. The stock settled with nearly 44 per cent gains on bourses. It ended at ₹602.80 on the NSE and at ₹604.45 on the BSE. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investment, said Kusumgar's strong market debut was supported by robust investor demand and positive sentiment towards the defence sector. Nyati said the com-



STRONG DEBUT. Krishnan Iyer (left), Senior Vice-President, NSE, with Sapna Siddharth Kusumgar, JMD, and Siddharth Yogesh Kusumgar, CMD, Kusumgar, at the listing ceremony

pany operates in the niche engineered fabrics segment with strong entry barriers and long-term opportunities in aerospace and defence. However, she noted that the company's financial performance has weakened over the last three years, with declines in revenue, earnings per share and return on net worth. The ₹650-crore initial public offering of Kusumgar Ltd received a strong response from investors and

was subscribed 128.85 times overall. The portion reserved for qualified institutional buyers was subscribed 284.10 times. The category for non-institutional investors was booked 165.46 times, while retail investors subscribed their quota 26.47 times. As the IPO was an offer-for-sale, the Mumbai-based company will not receive any proceeds from the issue and the funds will go entirely to the selling shareholders.

Groww Q1 net doubles to ₹735 cr

Our Bureau Bengaluru

Billionbrains Garage Ventures Ltd, the parent company of digital investment platform Groww, reported a strong financial performance for Q1FY27, with profit after tax (PAT) rising 94.4 per cent y-o-y to ₹735 crore, compared with ₹378 crore in Q1 FY26, driven by revenue growth, operating leverage having played out across all the cost buckets and increasing contribution from newer products such as MTF and commodity. The company's total income grew 63.3 per cent to ₹1,549 crore (₹948 crore), while revenue from operations increased 66 per cent to ₹1,501 crore (₹904 crore). Groww has emerged as the market leader in retail commodity derivatives, according to its Q1 FY27 results. The company's market share stands at 28.6 per cent, with notional ADTO of ₹2.43 lakh crore across MCX and NSE, displacing Angel One (₹2.36 lakh crore across MCX, NCDEX and NSE), the segment leader until now.

IGX files initial papers for IPO

Our Bureau New Delhi

Indian Gas Exchange (IGX) has filed preliminary papers with markets regulator the Securities and Exchange Board of India to launch an initial public offering. In a BSE filing on Wednesday, Indian Energy Exchange (IEX) said that IGX, its associate company, had filed a draft red herring prospectus with SEBI and BSE on July 14, in connection with the proposed IPO. The issue comprises an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 1.671 crore shares by IEX, it added. IEX currently holds a 47.3 per cent stake in IGX. The OFS will reduce its stake to 25 per cent. IGX's other shareholders include GAIL, ONGC, IOC, Adani Total Gas, Torrent Gas and NSE Investments. The primary objective of the IPO is to achieve benefits of listing on stock exchanges, which it anticipates will enhance visibility, strengthen brand image and provide a public market for its shares. IGX is India's first online platform for trading in nat-

ural gas. During Q1 FY27, IGX traded gas volume of 27.48 million mBtu (692.70 MSCM), representing an increase of 47.94 per cent q-o-q and 11.91 per cent on y-o-y basis. **TRADING PLATFORM** The platform provides a marketplace to trade in spot and forward gas contracts at designated delivery points across five regional hubs. It currently offers trades at 19 delivery points including 6 LNG terminals, 9 domestic gas field landfall points and 4 pipeline interconnections. IGX offers delivery-based trading in 10 standardised natural gas contracts — Intra-day, Day-Ahead, Daily, Weekday, Weekly, Fortnightly and Monthly (up to 12 months), Balance of Month and two Long Duration Contracts-3 Months and 6 Months. IGX facilitates price discovery reflective of Indian natural gas supply and demand, showcased by its benchmark price index, GIXI. It operates under the regulatory framework of the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board.

BROKER'S CALL.

InCred Equities

PRIVI SPECIALITY CHEM (ADD) Target: ₹4,796 CMP: ₹3,695.10 Privi Speciality Chemicals has evolved from a two-product aroma-chemical manufacturer in 1992 into an integrated supplier with more than 75 products and relationships with leading fragrance houses and FMCG companies. Aroma chemicals form a small share of final product costs, but quality and timely supply are critical. Long qualification cycles and a broad product basket make customer relationships highly sticky. Privi Speciality Chemicals is investing around ₹1,200-1,250 crore to expand its capacity from 48,000 tonnes to 66,000-72,000 tonnes over the next three years. The expansion includes phased brownfield additions, the ramp-up of PRIGIN and new-product blocks. A shift towards higher-value woody, amber, floral, musk and fine-fragrance products should also improve realisation. New products such as menthol, maltol, cyclopentanone and furfural broaden its addressable market. We expect gross margin to remain around 48 per cent and EBITDA margin at 25-26 per cent, supported by higher utilisation, a better product mix and operating leverage. Capacity ramp-up and improving realisation should lift EPS to around ₹123 in FY28F and ₹151 in FY29F. Applying a conservative 35x one-year forward P/E to the average FY28F-29F EPS of ₹137 gives a target price of around ₹4,796. Sticky customers, visible capacity growth, backward integration and a wider specialty pipeline support our Add rating on the stock. Downside risk: Supply chain problems which can lead to raw material cost inflation.

Elara Securities

NUVOCO VISTAS (ACCUMULATE) Target: ₹391 CMP: ₹376.35 Nuvoco Vistas Corporation reported EBITDA of about ₹570 crore in Q1FY27, respectively due to better-than-expected realisation. The management expects fuel costs to remain broadly stable in the coming quarters, while packaging costs may drop by about ₹20-25/tonne. Although power costs may increase by about ₹40-50/tonne in the next two-three months due to maintenance shutdown of two kilns, improved rail availability during the monsoon and the implementation of lean discounts on clinker and cement movement may partially offset the cost pressure. Nuvoco commissioned its 2-mt grinding unit at Surat in July, ahead of schedule. The 3.5-mt clinker unit at Kutch and the 2.5-mt grinding unit with WHRS remain on track for commissioning in H1FY27. In East India, the Panagarh and Jojobera expansion projects are nearing completion, while Jaipur and Arasmeta are expected to be commissioned by FY28. Upon completion, cement and clinker capacities will increase to about 35 mt 17 mt, respectively, supporting long-term volume growth. Also, the phased commissioning of Vadraj Cement (VCL) assets, along with capacity expansion in East India, is likely to enhance growth visibility and support volume expansion. We raise our FY27E EBITDA estimate by about 9 per cent and FY28E/29E estimates by about 3 per cent each, factoring in better pricing. As our stock offers an upside of about 15 per cent, we revise our rating to Accumulate from Buy with a higher TP of ₹391 based on 9x March 2028E EV/EBITDA. businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

BlueStone Jewellery & Lifestyle (₹627.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for BlueStone Jewellery and Lifestyle. The stock has been moving up inside a channel. The 3 per cent rise on Wednesday has taken the share price well above an intermediate resistance level of ₹600. This indicates that the upmove is gaining momentum. Moving average cross overs on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish. BlueStone Jewellery and Lifestyle share price can rise to ₹700, the upper end of the range, in the coming weeks. Traders can buy the stock now at ₹627. Accumulate on dips at ₹610. Keep the stop-loss



at ₹585 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹635 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹645. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹655 and ₹675 when the price touches ₹665 and ₹685 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹695. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24075 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23950	23840	24300	24600	Go long on a bounce from 23950 with a stop-loss at 23910

₹815 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
811	806	820	830	Go long only above 820. Stop-loss can be kept at 818

₹1077 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1070	1055	1095	1120	Take fresh shorts below 1070 with a stop-loss at 1075

₹277 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
275	270	278	280	Go short on a break below 275 with a stop-loss at 276

₹247 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
245	243	250	250	Go long now and at 246. Stop-loss can be kept at 244

₹1296 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1285	1270	1310	1330	Go short only below 1285. Keep the stop-loss at 1290

₹1029 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1020	1000	1040	1060	Go short on a reversal from 1040 with a stop-loss at 1045

₹2187 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2175	2150	2210	2245	Go long on a break above 2210. Keep the stop-loss at 2205

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
HDFC Bank	815.45	20.23	15.85	11.33	
Eternal Ltd.	294.80	13.66	777.30	1.93	
ICI(ICI Bank	1416.20	13.30	17.53	9.20	
State Bank	1030.10	13.27	10.97	3.86	
Bajaj Finance	1021.30	8.61	32.89	2.48	
UltraTech Cement	11812.00	8.17	42.51	1.27	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1033.80	6.09	24.26	1.31	
Bajaj Auto	10323.00	3.80	27.29	1.04	
Eicher Motors	7404.50	3.76	36.85	0.93	
Reliance Ind	1295.50	3.69	18.31	7.94	
HDFC Life	568.75	3.18	64.18	0.55	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5171.00	3.11	0.00	1.06	
Asian Paints	2670.00	2.86	58.28	1.10	
Maruti Suzuki	13583.00	2.68	29.09	0.61	
SBI Life	1866.40	2.56	75.79	0.76	
ITC	276.65	2.32	16.49	2.42	
Sun Pharma	1951.50	2.06	40.69	1.87	
Tech Mahindra	1498.70	2.00	30.57	0.86	
Max Healthcare	1102.70	1.59	74.40	0.74	
Adani Ports	1829.10	1.16	32.97	1.22	
Apollo Hosp	8934.00	0.75	64.15	0.83	
Bharat Elec	410.95	0.66	49.55	1.34	
Titan	4579.40	0.51	80.12	1.71	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	236.59	0.44	100.09	0.70	
HCL Tech	1168.00	0.30	19.03	1.12	
Cipla	1438.00	-0.01	30.08	0.73	
Trent Ltd.	2867.70	-0.10	88.84	0.87	
Tata Motors PV	333.00	-0.16	4087.94	0.63	
Kotak Bank	378.40	-0.40	12.51	2.53	
NestleIndia	1424.60	-0.42	78.50	0.93	
ONGC	247.18	-1.46	6.25	0.87	
Wipro	174.65	-1.56	13.83	0.45	
Coal India	427.55	-1.60	8.48	0.93	
TataConsumerProduct	1085.50	-1.72	69.45	0.64	
M&M	3082.90	-2.03	20.59	2.50	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1229.80	-2.32	24.46	0.68	
Glass Ind	3086.10	-2.24	20.39	1.06	
Adani Enter	3150.60	-2.41	41.19	0.82	
Bajaj Finserve	1849.60	-2.48	15.05	0.97	
TCS	2189.20	-2.54	15.32	2.03	
Axis Bank	1312.30	-3.32	15.38	3.42	
Hind Unilever	2102.60	-3.41	46.69	1.69	
NTPC	344.35	-3.93	12.12	1.46	
JSW Steel	1226.90	-4.26	11.76	1.04	
PowerGrid Corp	280.70	-5.39	16.39	1.15	
Tata Steel	185.26	-5.43	21.25	1.39	
Hindalco	955.80	-5.85	16.04	1.26	
Bharti Airtel	1918.30	-12.09	34.56	5.29	
Infosys	1076.30	-12.72	14.82	3.42	
L&T	3783.90	-16.56	27.46	4.02	
Pts: Impact on index movement					
Nifty Next 50 Movers					
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Abb India	7204.50	48.06	96.62	1.54	
Hdfc Amc	279.20	41.47	40.93	2.26	
Cholamandlamin&Fin	1803.90	41.08	29.39	3.17	
Tata Motors Cv	423.50	37.64	51.51	3.59	
Indian OilCorp	140.24	34.93	4.53	2.13	
Divis Lab	7273.00	31.47	75.19	3.75	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	929.15	30.75	122.28	2.59	
Siemens Energy India .	3497.40	27.94	95.09	1.26	
Indian Hotels Co .	743.20	25.48	47.08	2.65	
Bree Cement	26925.00	25.28	55.56	1.46	
Sptec	309.60	25.24	5.20	2.55	
Cummins India	5549.50	22.17	65.13	3.05	
Hyundai Motor India .	2002.90	18.05	29.96	1.16	
Zyduslifesciences	1156.90	17.08	22.72	1.18	
Siemens	3571.80	15.93	82.98	1.28	
Tata Power	380.90	15.64	23.78	2.58	
Torrent Pharma	5017.80	15.62	79.43	2.14	
Gail (India)	173.15	12.96	15.02	1.90	
Macrotech Developers .	1162.40	12.32	33.85	1.31	
Pidlittind	1568.80	12.17	64.62	1.97	
Britannia Ind	5315.50	11.05	50.47	2.54	
Ambuja Cements	435.25	9.96	19.68	1.10	
Union Bank	172.38	9.68	6.77	1.35	
Bank Of Baroda	248.15	8.43	6.39	1.87	
Canara Bank	126.47	7.19	6.42	1.73	
Punjab Natl Bank	105.71	7.17	6.58	1.48	
Avenueuper	3929.30	6.33	83.82	2.57	
Bajaj Holdings	10531.00	5.71	11.97	1.85	

QUICKLY.

Gold gains as traders focus on W. Asia tensions



Gold prices reversed earlier declines and edged up on Wednesday after US producer prices unexpectedly fell in June, although escalating tensions in West Asia limited gains. Spot gold rose 0.3 per cent to \$4,067.60 per ounce by 1258 GMT. US gold futures gained 0.2 per cent to \$4,075.80. REUTERS

Copper slips on weak Chinese economic data

London: Copper prices edged lower after disappointing economic data in top metals consumer China, but supply concerns due to mine disruptions and the West Asian conflict helped limit losses. Benchmark three month copper on the LME lost 0.2 per cent to \$13,612 a tonne by 1430 GMT. LME lead lost 0.9 per cent to \$1,849. REUTERS

Raw sugar heads back near 2-week lows



London: Raw sugar futures on ICE slipped, heading back near two-week lows amid a pause in El Nino-linked excess rains in top grower Brazil. Raw sugar fell 0.4 per cent to 14.82 cents per lb at 1318 GMT. Dealers said weather conditions in Brazil have been clear for the past few weeks, allowing the harvest to progress. White sugar was down 2.7 per cent at \$451.10 a tonne. REUTERS

July rain offers relief as overall deficit during monsoon shrinks

GAP NARROWS. Rainfall during first half of July was 23.3 mm, 4% below normal: IMD

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

India's seasonal rainfall deficit since June 1 has narrowed to 23 per cent from 37 per cent at the end of June, aided by a much-improved first half of July, when rainfall was just 4 per cent below normal, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

Cumulative rainfall since June 1 stands at 227 mm against the Long Period Average (LPA) of 294.2 mm. However, the deficit remains widespread, with 21 meteorological subdivisions — covering 56 per cent of the country's geographical area — still classified as “deficient”, having received at least 20 per cent less rainfall than normal.

BREAK PHASE

A lull in the monsoon since July 10 has once again widened the rainfall gap.

Between July 11 and 15, pan-India rainfall plunged to 67 per cent below normal, leaving 28 States and Union Territories under either “deficient” or “large deficient” rainfall conditions.

The dry spell also weighed on the first fortnight of July, with 17 meteorological subdivisions, which account for 42 per cent of the country's geographical area, reporting below-normal rainfall.

A fresh low-pressure system forming over the Bay of Bengal is expected to bring much-needed rainfall to West Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, eastern Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh.

However, the rest of the country is likely to remain largely dry until the monsoon revives in a more broad manner.

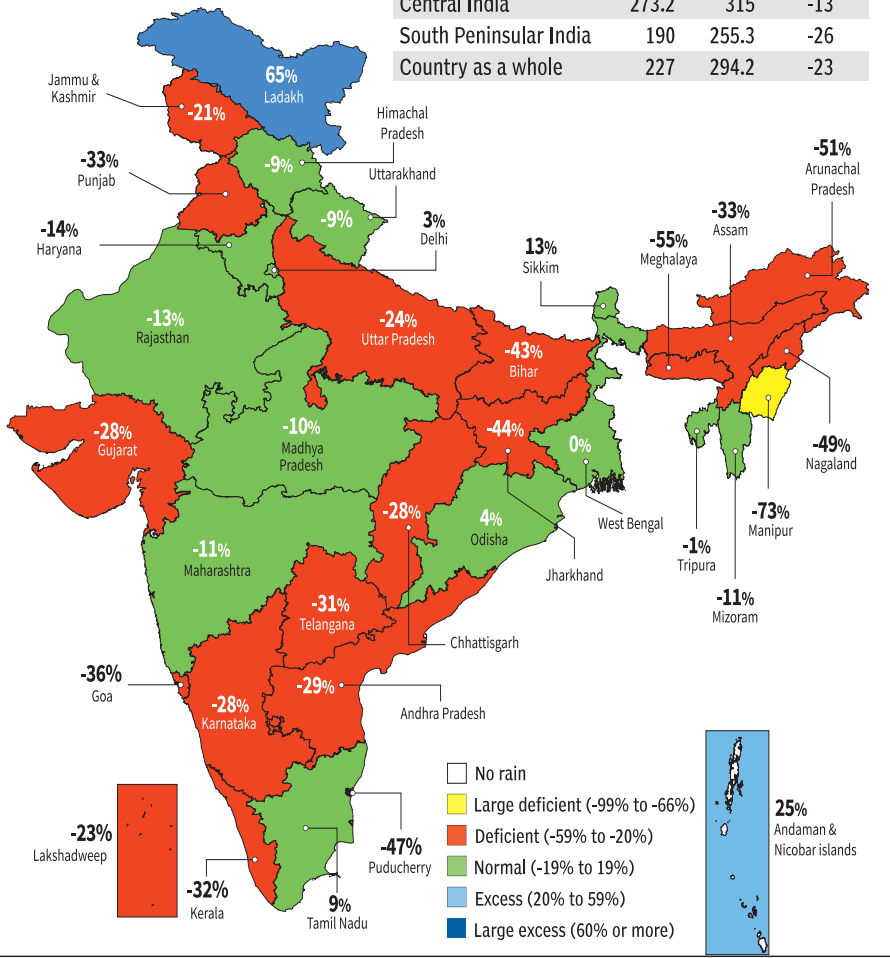
Patchy monsoon

Cumulative rainfall in 738 districts, per data received (June 1 to July 15)

Large excess: 3%	Deficient: 44%
Excess: 12%	Large deficient: 10%
Normal: 30%	No rain: 1%

Rainfall (in mm) upto July 15

Region	Actual	Normal	% departure from LPA
East & N-E India	348	540.2	-36
N-W India	137.5	168.7	-19
Central India	273.2	315	-13
South Peninsular India	190	255.3	-26
Country as a whole	227	294.2	-23



Source: IMD Cumulative rainfall from June 1 to July 15

MIXED PATTERN

According to the latest IMD data, India received 123.3 mm of rainfall during the first half of July against the normal 128.9 mm, translating into an overall deficit of just 4 per cent.

The regional picture, however, remains uneven. North-West India recorded

84.1 mm of rainfall, a deficit of 7 per cent.

Central India, the country's key rain-fed agricultural belt spanning Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Gujarat, received 188.6 mm of rainfall, 30 per cent above the normal of 144.7 mm.

The southern peninsula

continued to face a sharp rainfall shortfall.

Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Puducherry together received just 61.1 mm of rainfall, 35 per cent below the normal 94.3 mm.

The East and the North-East region fared no better.

‘Low’ set to deepen, bolster monsoon over East India

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon is gaining strength with a low-pressure area over the north-west Bay of Bengal on course to intensify a round, setting the stage for widespread heavy rain across parts of the country over the coming week.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said the system, centred over the north-west Bay and the adjoining north Odisha-West Bengal coast on Wednesday morning, is expected to strengthen into a well-marked low-pressure area, before moving inland across north Odisha and West Bengal in the next two days.

MONSOON TROUGH

Like its predecessor that lingered unusually long, un-

leashing repeated spells of flooding rain over Central and West India, the current system also appears set for an extended stay, promising a sustained revival of the monsoon after its recent weak phase.

A key driver of the renewed activity is the monsoon trough, which stretched from Jammu through Dehradun, Shahjahanpur, Basti, Patna, Bankura and the centre of the low-pressure area, before dipping into the east-central Bay, enabling the system to continuously draw fresh moisture from the sea.

N-W INDIA RAIN

Further boosting prospects for rain is a western disturbance positioned as a cyclonic circulation over north Pakistan and adjoining Jammu. Another disturb-

ance is likely to affect North-West India by Sunday.

Reflecting that possibility, the IMD has forecast isolated heavy rainfall over Uttarakhnad during the next four days. Heavy rain is also forecast over Jammu and Kashmir-Ladakh and West Uttar Pradesh for three days from Sunday.

The IMD said Himachal Pradesh is expected to receive heavy showers on Saturday and Sunday, while Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh and Delhi could see heavy rainfall on Monday and Tuesday. East Uttar Pradesh is likely to remain under heavy rain for five days, beginning Saturday. Heavy rain will spread into parts of Central India.

Fairly widespread rainfall is expected over Kerala and Mahe for five days from Friday, coastal Karnataka for four days from Saturday.

Coffee output pegged up at 4.04 lt

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Coffee production for the 2026-27 crop year, beginning in October, is projected at 4.04 lakh tonnes, about 8 per cent higher than the final estimate of 3.73 lakh tonnes (lt) for 2025-26, according to the Coffee Board's post-blossom estimate. The post-blossom estimate, based on flowering triggered by pre-monsoon showers and initial crop setting, is the Board's first production forecast for the season. The final output typically turns out to be lower than the initial estimate.

For 2025-26, the Board initially estimated production at 4.03 lt, but the final estimate was lowered to 3.73 lt. For 2026-27, arabica produc-

tion is estimated at 1.2 lt, up from the final estimate of 1.11 lt last year, while robusta output is pegged at 2.84 lt against 2.62 lt.

KARNATAKA LEADS

Karnataka, the country's largest coffee-producing State, is projected to harvest 2.79 lt, up from 2.56 lt last year, with higher production expected across Kodagu, Chikkamagaluru and Hassan. Arabica output in the State is estimated at 84,015 tonnes (79,145 tonnes), while robusta production is pegged at 1.95 lt (1.77 lt).

In Kodagu, the largest producing district, total output is projected at 1.31 lt against 1.21 lt last year. Arabica production is estimated at 20,720 tonnes (20,060 tonnes), while robusta output is seen rising to 1.10 lt

from 1.01 lakh tonnes.

In Chikkamagaluru, arabica production is estimated at 43,295 tonnes (41,185 tonnes) and robusta at 58,860 tonnes (53,575 tonnes). Hassan is projected to produce 20,000 tonnes of arabica (17,900 tonnes) and 25,700 tonnes of robusta (22,850 tonnes).

GAINS IN KERALA, AP

Kerala's coffee output is estimated at 84,570 tonnes, up from 80,350 tonnes last year. In Wayanad, the State's largest coffee-growing district, robusta production is projected to increase to 72,450 tonnes from 68,800 tonnes.

Tamil Nadu's production is expected to remain largely stable at 19,720 tonnes, marginally lower than last year's 19,975 tonnes.

US counts on India as key cotton buyer

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

The US views India as a market with potential to purchase its cotton and will likely emerge as a key importer in 2026, said Gary Adams, President of the US Cotton Trust Protocol.

“If we look at India, it is an important market for US cotton. In fact, in this marketing year, we are just competing for India as the fourth-largest market for US cotton,” he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

With the area under cotton down in India and concerns over the monsoon, it could be a “stronger” market in 2026.

In its latest *Cotton: World Market and Trade* report, the US Department of Agriculture (USDA) has raised India's cotton imports this season to September to 56.9 lakh bales (170 kg each) from the earlier 53.18 lakh bales.



Gary Adams, President of the US Cotton Trust Protocol

CHINA NOT STRONG

Vietnam has been the largest market for US cotton exports over the past year. It has emerged as a strong market. Bangladesh is a steady market, particularly as its textile industry continues to grow.

“The market that has not been as strong over the course of the past year is China. With just some of the trade tensions that are going on between the US and China, we're not seeing as much US cotton going to

China over the past year,” said Adams.

However, the USDA, in its latest estimates for the 2026-27 season, has projected 1.5-2 per cent increase in global cotton demand from last year, he said. The USDA has forecast production to increase to 117.3 million US bales (217.7 kg), while consumption will likely increase to 122 million bales, up 200,000 bales.

The concern of the US Cotton Trust Protocol, set up six years ago, was increase in energy prices. If prices continue to rule firm, it could have an impact on consumption or force consumers to become more conservative. “I think that certainly could play out if we see this continue forward later into this year,” said Adams, who is in India to meet the textiles industry and attend the Bharat Trade show. High oil prices could impact overall expenditure on fuels. “That's coming into

play, particularly as consumers look at their spending habits. The other factor is that higher oil prices have translated into an increase in prices of synthetic fibres, such as polyester, that are petroleum based,” he said.

This has resulted in renewed demand for cotton, said the US Cotton Trust Protocol President, adding that “cotton prices are holding in at a fairly good level”.

On the Inter-Continental Exchange, cotton is currently quoting at a two-month high of over 82 cents a pound on higher crude oil prices in the wake of renewed US-Iran tensions.

The US Cotton Trust Protocol wants the import duty on cotton removed for short and medium staple cotton too. Currently, the government has suspended the 11 per cent import duty only on long staple cotton till September 30. The association has been communicating this to the government.

Cotton firms up on dip in area, rise in global price

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Cotton prices have strengthened, tracking the rally in global markets amid concerns over lower acreage here due to deficient rainfall. Acreage was down 15 per cent at 79.54 lakh hectares (lh) as of July 10, compared with 93.95 lh a year ago, according to Agriculture Ministry data.

The Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) has raised its selling price by ₹800 per candy (356 kg) over the past two days, as demand from mills and traders remains firm.

“The market is tight and New York prices have also firmed up, with the ICE futures rising from around 75-76 cents per pound to 81-82 cents,” said Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur. “Uncertainty over the coming crop due to the delayed monsoon is support-



ing the market,” he said, adding that the CCI sold over 1.2 lakh bales on Monday and 1.5 lakh bales on Tuesday. Multinational trading firms are also offloading stocks at prices around ₹1,000 per candy higher than the CCI's rates, he added.

RAINS HOLD THE KEY

Das Boob said the cotton crop that has already germinated now urgently needs rainfall. “There is no rain in parts of Karnataka and Telangana, where cotton has already been sown. If it doesn't rain now, it may be-

come difficult,” he said.

However, Atul Ganatra, Chairman of the Crop Committee of the Cotton Association of India (CAI), remained optimistic despite the rainfall deficit. “El Nino will not impact the cotton crop. Actually, it will help in increasing the cotton sowing area. Less rain would mean better yield, quality and quantity,” he said.

According to Ganatra, cotton sowing had been completed on around 80 lh compared with 86 lh during the same period last year. “By July 25, sowing will cross 100 lh as almost all growing regions have received good spells of rain. With the current pause in rainfall, farmers are speeding up cotton sowing,” he said.

He added that acreage in South India is 20 per cent higher than last year.

“Due to the late rain, farmers now have the only option of sowing cotton. Total cotton sowing will be 125-130 lh, about 10-15 per cent

higher than last year,” Ganatra said.

ADEQUATE SUPPLIES

He said large spinning mills were buying cotton around ₹64,000 per candy despite already holding stocks sufficient for three to four months. “As they have bought at cheaper rates, they are buying at the current prices to average,” he said, adding that most large mills had stocks until November, while some were covered until the end of December.

Anand Popat, a cotton broker based in Rajkot, said that overall cotton availability in India remained comfortable. However, premium quality cotton is relatively scarce, with much of the stock held by the CCI and multinational trading firms.

“This could keep cotton prices well-supported during the remaining months of the season,” Popat said.

Daily *kapas* arrivals have declined to around 7,000-8,000 bales.

Augmont Enterprises, NSE tie-up to boost adoption of e-gold receipts

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Augmont Enterprises, an integrated gold trading platform, has entered into a strategic tie-up with the NSE to accelerate the adoption of electronic gold receipts (EGRs) and expects the government to resolve the GST issue soon.

EGRs are SEBI-regulated, exchange-traded instrument that converts physical gold into a dematerialised security held in investors' demat accounts.

GST ISSUE

Ketan Kothari, Whole-time Director, Augmont Enterprises, said the company had already developed the required IT infrastructure and expects to list its EGRs in the next three months, provided

the GST issue is settled.

Augmont will deploy its comprehensive ecosystem for EGR creation, redemption, liquidity provision, delivery and price discovery — bringing together its over 4.2 crore registered users, about 4,975 jeweller network on the SPOT platform, over 4,600 retail touchpoints, 80 Gold For All stores and API integrations with leading stockbrokers and financial service providers.

Augmont is also an India Good Delivery accredited refiner, empanelled across exchanges including MCX for futures delivery across all gold contracts, and is an authorised participant for gold ETFs, creating a natural bridge between the ETF and EGR ecosystems.

FULL PRICE EXPOSURE

EGRs enable physical gold to

be held, traded, pledged and lent through a single exchange-regulated framework. India holds an estimated 30,000-35,000 tonnes of gold in private hands.

Gold depositors under EGR will retain full price exposure and can earn a return by lending their gold to jewellery manufacturers through the NSE's securities lending and borrowing platform.

Sriram Krishnan, Chief Business Development Officer, NSE, said the NSE EGR framework had been created to establish a transparent, efficient and exchange-regulated marketplace for physical gold in India.

Surendra Mehta, National Secretary, India Bullion and Jewellers Association, said EGRs can be 100 times of what the tokenised gold market is today.

Stay out of copper futures

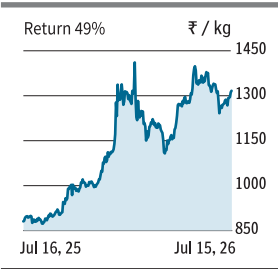
Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Copper prices have recovered well in the past three weeks. The copper futures contract on the MCX fell to a low of ₹1,240 per kg in June. From there, the contract has rebounded and is currently trading at ₹1,317.

COMMODITY CALL.

The trend is down for the contract since mid-May this year. For now, it looks like the recent bounce is just a corrective rise within the downtrend. The immediate resistance is at ₹1,320 and above that, ₹1,340 is the next important resistance.

A strong break above ₹1,340 could take it higher to ₹1,370. That can give some breather. However, to turn the outlook convincingly bullish, the contract has to



breach ₹1,370 decisively. Only then will the upside open up for a rise to ₹1,420 and higher.

If the contract turns down from ₹1,340, a fall to ₹1,300-₹1,270 is possible. That will also keep the contract under pressure to see ₹1,200 on the downside. Overall, it is a wait and watch situation now. For now, we can allow for a rise to ₹1,340.

TRADE STRATEGY

Since it is not clear whether the contract can breach its resistance or not, we suggest traders to stay out of the market.

CAC49 nod for India to develop Codex standard for cashew kernels

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The 49th session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (CAC49) has approved India's proposal to undertake new work for the development of a Codex standard for cashew kernels. It adopted seven Codex standards and guidelines developed under India's chairmanship and co-chairmanship in Geneva last week.

Led by Rajit Punhani, CEO of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), the Indian delegation participated actively in the Commission's deliberations along with technical experts from FSSAI and the Spices Board.

The Commission adopted the Codex Standards for dried coriander seeds and

fresh curry leaves, both developed under India's chairmanship.

CORIANDER SEEDS

The standard for dried coriander seeds would facilitate trade in one of the world's most widely traded spices, while the standard for fresh curry leaves provides an international benchmark for this regionally important culinary herb.

CAC49 also adopted five Codex texts developed under India's co-chairmanship. These include the Codex Standards for vanilla and large cardamom, which establish internationally harmonised quality requirements for these globally traded commodities; the annexes to guidelines for the safe use and reuse of water in food production and processing, promoting sustain-

able water management while ensuring food safety; the guidelines for the control of campylobacter and salmonella in chicken meat, strengthening measures to reduce food-borne illnesses associated with poultry; and the provisions relevant to joint presentation and multipack formats under the general standard for the labelling of pre-packaged foods, providing greater clarity and consistency in food labelling requirements.

A key achievement for India at CAC49 was the Commission's approval of India's proposal to undertake new work for the development of a Codex Standard for cashew kernels under the Codex Committee on Processed Fruits and Vegetables.

The proposal received overwhelming support from Codex members.

QUICKLY.

Former ISRO chief joins board of Agnikul Cosmos



Chennai: Chennai-based space-tech startup Agnikul Cosmos has announced that Somanath S, former Chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), has joined the company's Board of Directors as an observer as it prepares for its ambitious Mission 02 project. **OUR BUREAU**

Immuneel, TMC tie up for gene therapy research

Bengaluru: Bengaluru-based startup Immuneel Therapeutics has signed an MoU with Tata Memorial Centre (TMC). Under the MoU, the two will collaborate on a broad range of initiatives in cell and gene therapy, including clinical studies, translational research. **OUR BUREAU**

Bengaluru airport extends lead over Chennai in air cargo movement

WIDE GAP. Industry sources attribute better infrastructure connectivity to Bengaluru’s all-round performance

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Bengaluru airport has widened its lead over Chennai in air cargo handling, driven by strong growth in international freight handling. The shift marks a reversal from a year ago when Chennai was marginally ahead in international cargo. Industry sources attributed better infrastructure connectivity to Bengaluru's all-round performance. In May 2025, Chennai handled 28,208 tonnes of international cargo, slightly higher than Bengaluru's 27,992 tonnes. By May 2026, however, Bengaluru has overtaken its southern rival with 31,652 tonnes, while Chennai handled 29,721 tonnes, according to Airports Authority of India data. The gap has steadily widened over the past year,

Flying high (in tonnes)			
	May 2025	May 2026	Growth (%)
International			
Bengaluru	27,992	31,652	13.1
Chennai	28,208	29,721	5.4
Domestic			
Bengaluru	15,009	17,578	17.1
Chennai	8,344	9,015	8
Total			
Bengaluru	43,001	49,230	14.5
Chennai	36,552	38,736	6

Source: Airports Authority of India

with Bengaluru's international cargo growing 13.1 per cent year-on-year in May compared with Chennai's 5.4 per cent. The trend was also evident in April, when Bengaluru recorded 11.6 per cent growth against Chennai's 9.3 per cent. Bengaluru also maintained a commanding lead in domestic cargo. Domestic freight carried by the Bengaluru airport rose 17.1 per cent year-on-year to 17,578 tonnes in May, while Chennai recorded an 8 per cent increase to 9,015 tonnes. Bengaluru retained its position as India's third-largest air cargo airport after Delhi and Mumbai, while Chennai ranked fourth.

Innovation gathers pace in India’s lifesciences sector

Our Bureau
Mumbai

With about 10 novel drug molecules in as many years, the momentum is building for innovation in India's pharmaceutical and lifesciences sector, says a report by the Boston Consulting Group (BCG) and HealthKoIs. But there remain gaps in the funding, and research ecosystem that still need to be fixed, it points out. Companies are pursuing multiple pathways to compete globally, the report said, pointing to Glenmark's out-licensing deal with AbbVie

that brought in an upfront payment of \$700 million, with up to \$1.2 billion in milestone payments, and CAR-T therapies developed by startups like Immuno-ACT, among others. "The innovation pipeline expanded approximately 1.5x to more than 1,095 drug discovery programs across 195 companies, while pharma patent families originating from India climbed from roughly 716 in 2015 to 2,995 in 2024, lifting India's share of global pharma patents from 3-4 percent to about 10 percent," the report said, adding that the shift was qualitative.



Four enabling features contributing to this shift included, the \$5 billion-odd government funding for early-stage and translational research; academia - industry partnerships and technology-transfers; regu-

latory reform collapsing drug-development timelines from 180-270 days to 60-120; and shared research and development (R&D) and manufacturing infrastructure such as Genome Valley and C-CAMP, the report said. "Early proof points of lab-to-market translation are already visible, including BIRSA 101, India's first indigenously developed CR-ISPRA-based therapeutic, and NexCAR19, priced at roughly one-tenth of comparable overseas CAR-T therapies," it added. Private equity and venture capital investment in

pharma rose 2.1x in five years to \$731 million for the year ended March 2026, and biotech startups grew from roughly 1,500 to 2,400, the report said. **FUNDING GAP** India conducts only about 4 percent of global clinical trials, and annual pharmaceutical R&D spending remains at \$2 to 3 billion compared with \$70 to 75 billion in the United States, the report noted. Priyanka Aggarwal, Managing Director and Senior Partner, BCG India and Southeast Asia Leader (Healthcare Practice) said,

there was a shift in ambition "from replication to origination, and from process excellence to scientific discovery." Ajay Mahipal, Co-Founder and General Partner, HealthKoIs, said, "India is building a differentiated advantage by combining cost, data and scientific talent in ways few countries can match." The report was based on 30-plus interviews with founders, pharmaceutical executives, investors in India and overseas, together with analysis of patents, venture investments, innovation pipelines and global datasets, it said.

Payment firms Stripe, Advent table \$53 b offer to buy PayPal

Reuters



Payments company Stripe and private equity firm Advent International have made a joint offer to acquire PayPal Holdings Inc for \$60.50 per share, in a deal that would value the payments company at more than \$53 billion, two people said. The offer, submitted earlier this month, is backed by about \$50 billion in committed financing from banks, said one of the people. The offer represents around a 28 per cent premium to PayPal's closing share price on Tuesday. The people, who are familiar with the matter, declined to be named as the deal discussions are confidential. PayPal, Stripe and Advent declined to comment. The proposal follows an initial approach made in early April, the sources said. Stripe and Advent have not

received a response from PayPal and are seeking to advance discussions in the coming weeks, the sources added.

EQUAL STAKE

Under the proposal, Stripe and Advent would jointly own PayPal, with each holding an equal stake, rather than breaking up the company, the people said. There is no certainty the approach will result in a transaction, they added. PayPal shares were last up 16.2 per cent in pre-market trading. Founded in the late 1990s,

PayPal was an early player in digital payments, but has faced increasing competition as consumers have embraced alternative payment methods and rivals such as Apple Pay and Google Pay have gained market share. The company's market capitalization peaked at about \$360 billion in 2021 and fell to as low as roughly \$36 billion this year. It has lost more than 40 per cent of its market value over the past 12 months. In April, the company split its operations into three units covering checkout, consumer financial services Venmo, and payments and crypto. The potential PayPal transaction, if completed, will add to the recent M&A activity in the global payments sector, where buyers have pursued targets amid rapid changes in financial technology and the rise of artificial intelligence.

Air India crash: Draft final report by Oct, agency tells SC

Aaratika Bhaumik
New Delhi

More than a year after an Air India Boeing 787 Dreamliner crashed shortly following take-off from Ahmedabad on June 12, 2025, killing 260 people (229 passengers and 12 crew members on board), the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) has informed the Supreme Court that it expects to complete its investigation within six weeks, with a "draft final report" likely to be ready by October. "In view of the nature, scale and complexity of the present accident, the AAIB has carefully assessed the timeline for completion of the investigation. In all probability, the investigative activities, subject to the resolution of pending external dependencies, are expected to be completed within six weeks," said an affidavit filed by the AAIB Director General ahead of a July 17 hearing in a batch of petitions

seeking an independent investigation into the crash. As required under the rules of the International Civil Aviation Organisation (ICAO), the "draft final report" will first be shared with the National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), the United States agency representing the State of Design and Manufacture, for its comments. According to the Bureau, the consultation process could take between 30 and 60 days. **PILOT-BLAME** The court was further informed that the investigation team has interviewed several witnesses, including Air India and Boeing 787 pilots, crew members who had previously flown with the pilots of the accident aircraft, air traffic control personnel, and specialists in human factors and crew resource management. The Bureau, however, acknowledged that "media speculation" and the "nar-



rative attributing blame worthiness to the pilots" had made some witnesses "restrictive and non-responsive" during the course of the investigation.

PARALLEL PROBE

The affidavit also opposed the petitioners' plea for a court-monitored or independent inquiry, contending that the investigation was being conducted in accordance with international standards and the applicable legal framework, leaving no scope for judicial oversight or a parallel probe. "It is thus respectfully submitted that the statutory

and treaty framework governing aircraft accident investigation constitutes a carefully layered legal regime... This constitutes a complete code, leaving no lacuna that could justify the creation of a parallel investigative body," it stated. The Bureau further informed the court that it had completed 49 of the 66 procedural steps prescribed for the investigation of a serious aircraft accident. According to the affidavit, every safeguard, including preservation of evidence, recovery and analysis of the flight recorders, participation of accredited representatives, technical examination of aircraft systems, stakeholder consultation, and circulation of the draft report, is being "scrupulously followed". **COCKPIT RECORDINGS** Vehemently opposing the petitioners' demand for disclosure of the cockpit voice recordings and airborne im-

age recordings, the AAIB stated that Rule 17(5) of the Aircraft (Investigation of Accidents and Incidents) Rules, 2025, places "an absolute statutory prohibition" on making such material public. "If witnesses and persons involved in aircraft operation know that their statements may be disclosed in aircraft accident or public proceedings, they will become guarded or unwilling to cooperate, thereby defeating the very purpose of safety investigation," the affidavit states. The Bureau further clarified that the sole purpose of the investigation is to improve aviation safety and prevent future accidents, and not to "apportion blame or determine civil or criminal liability." Earlier, the apex court had asked the Union government to place on record the procedural protocol governing the AAIB probe, observing that proceedings should not become a "blame game".

Chinese AI models narrow gap with US rivals, but await India’s language test

Siddhi Patil
Sanjana B
Bengaluru

The battle between American and Chinese AI models for India's enterprise market may ultimately be decided not by benchmark scores or token costs, but by how well they understand India's linguistic diversity. As Chinese models rapidly close the gap with their US rivals in reasoning and coding, both camps will need to prove they can handle code-switching, transliteration and domain-specific Indian languages to win enterprise adoption. Chinese models excel in low-cost inference and are also becoming increasingly capable at coding. For instance, Zai's GLM 5.2 outperforms most state-of-the-art models smaller than

Opus 4.7, meaning it can handle around 90 per cent of the tasks people typically use AI for. "Chinese models have reached roughly 90-95 per cent parity with their American counterparts in reasoning, coding, and multilingual capabilities. While they still have some ground to cover, their total cost of ownership is about one-tenth that of competing US models. As a result, they are already well positioned to deliver disproportionate value to enterprises," said Praveer Kochhar, CPO & Co-founder of KOGO AI. **NARROW GAP** According to Greyhound Research, DeepSeek's V4 Flash sits at \$0.14 and \$0.28 per million tokens, V4 Pro at \$1.74 and \$3.48 with a promotional rate of \$0.435 and \$0.87 currently posted, and

OpenAI's newest flagship tier, GPT-5.6 Sol, at \$5 and \$30. Meanwhile, Jaspreet Bindra, Co-founder & CEO, AI & Beyond, highlighted that Chinese models now match frontier American systems across benchmarks. Stanford's 2026 AI Index estimates that the performance gap between the leading US and Chinese models has narrowed to just 2.7 percentage points. However, American models retain advantages in complex agentic workflows, reliability, advanced research, safety tooling, enterprise integrations, and the surrounding cloud, developer, and application ecosystems. **NO MONOPOLY** "The model layer is becoming less scarce, more contestable and easier to substitute, which erodes the

Performance snapshot		
AI Model Family	Areas of Excellence	Monthly website visits (June 2026)
ChatGPT (OpenAI GPT-5 / o-series)	Long-horizon reasoning; advanced coding; multi-step planning; mathematical reasoning	5.56 b
Gemini (Google DeepMind Pro / Deep Think)	Academic science & STEM; Olympiad-level mathematics (IMO/AIME); multimodal reasoning	2.95 b
Claude (Anthropic Sonnet / Mythos / Fable)	Agentic coding (SWE-bench); graduate-level reasoning (GPQA/HLE); human preference; large codebase understanding	965.59 m
DeepSeek (V4 / R1)	Cost-efficient reasoning; competitive coding (LiveCodeBench); mathematical reasoning (MATH-500); open-source efficiency	483.80 m
Qwen (Alibaba Cloud Max / Qwen-Coder)	Local tool and agent workflows; multilingual capabilities; offline deployment; coding assistance	35.43 m
GLM (Zhipu AI)	Long-horizon software engineering; terminal-based agent workflows; cybersecurity and vulnerability detection	10.24 m

Sources: Epoch, AICPB

pricing power of premium providers and gives CIOs a credible basis for multi-

model architecture, even as dependence on cloud capacity, accelerators and integ-

ration ecosystems remains. Intelligence is becoming portable faster than the systems needed to operate it safely. China has not caught the entire AI stack, but has made the model layer far harder for anyone to monopolise," Sanchit Vir Gogia, Chief Analyst at Greyhound Research, explained. However, he observed, multilingual capability is routinely oversold. Qwen's third-generation family was trained across 119 languages and dialects, including Hindi, Tamil, and Bengali, and the leading US models carry broad global coverage with larger international product and support ecosystems. But neither origin guarantees dependable Indian-language performance. Currently, the strongest published score on Indian financial and regulatory language belongs to a US flag-

ship rather than any Chinese contender. Greyhound Research finds that Indian enterprises are evaluating Chinese models while committing to almost none in production. Evidence shows a pronounced skew towards US-managed platforms in named enterprise commitments, alongside vigorous developer and start-up interest in Chinese open weights. **AMERICAN BIAS** US AI models enjoy a distribution advantage, with enterprises relying on American hyperscalers for cloud infrastructure, security and procurement. Partnerships between AI providers and IT majors have further cemented their position. "Language will become a decisive selection factor rather than a marketing line. India's language market will

punish anyone who confuses vocabulary with understanding," Gogia shared. Meanwhile, India has a third strategic option. Homegrown models like Sarvam-105B, trained across 22 Indian languages, combined with the IndiaAI compute build-out, offer greater data residency and sovereign AI capabilities. Greyhound Research expects Indian enterprises to initially use Chinese AI models primarily for evaluations, developer tools, and private pilots, before adoption gradually expands through Indian-hosted deployments and approved marketplaces. Ultimately, while Indian enterprises will increasingly use foreign AI models, they will insist on Indian control through local infrastructure, compliance and deployment.



Sun Pharma’s semaglutide gets South Africa sale nod

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Drugmaker Sun Pharmaceutical Industries has received the green signal from the South African Health Products Regulatory Authority (SAHPRA) to manufacture and market a generic version of semaglutide injection in South Africa for the treatment of adults with inadequately controlled type 2 diabetes mellitus, the company said. The Mumbai-based drugmaker expects to launch the product shortly.

The development comes even as Dr Reddy's Laboratories recently said, its supplies to Canada would be delayed following an "out of specification" issue with certain batches that the company wanted to address. "South Africa is the second market after India where Sun Pharma has received approval for generic semaglutide," said Aalok Shangvi, Sun Pharma's Chief Operating Officer, adding that it reflected the company's ability to develop complex and quality generic

medicines for different markets. Sun's semaglutide version will be available as a pre-filled, multi-dose injectable pen in two strengths (2 mg/1.5 ml and 4 mg/3 ml) that allow flexible, once-weekly dosing, it said. **GENERIC MARKET** South Africa faces a growing burden of type 2 diabetes, driven in part by rapid urbanization and changing lifestyles, a note from the company said. Sun Pharma, Dr Reddy's and others had launched their generic versions of semaglutide in India, late March, after a patent on the product expired in India and other markets. Semaglutide is the active ingredient in weightloss and diabetes drugs Wegovy and Ozempic, from Novo Nordisk.

